User Manual for SkipQ Campus Canteen Food Ordering System

Version 1.0

Prepared by
Group #: 9
Group Name: Commit and Conquer

Name	Roll No.	Email
Aayush Gajeshwar	240024	aayushk24@iitk.ac.in
Aarya Bhatt	240016	aaryajb24@iitk.ac.in
Harpuneet Singh	240426	harpuneets24@iitk.ac.in
Jashan Mittal	240488	jashanm24@iitk.ac.in
Sourabh Sankhala	241036	sourabhs24@iitk.ac.in
Surya Prakash Pingali	241067	suryap24@iitk.ac.in
Pratham Sachin Todkar	240780	prathams24@iitk.ac.in
Jarapla Ashish Pamar	240487	japamar24@iitk.ac.in
Jatin Toshniwal	240489	jatin24@iitk.ac.in
Usnish Paul	241113	usnishp24@iitk.ac.in

Course / Mentor / Date
Course: CS253: Software Development and Operations
Mentor TA: Shaikh Imran
Date: 03 April 2026

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1. Overview

1.1 Purpose of This Manual

This manual walks you through every feature of SkipQ, the campus canteen food ordering platform built for IIT Kanpur. Whether you are a student ordering lunch, a canteen manager processing your daily queue, or an admin approving new canteens, this document covers each step with annotated screenshots and clear instructions.

1.2 What is SkipQ?

SkipQ is a web-based platform that lets IIT Kanpur students browse menus from multiple campus canteens, place food orders, pay using an in-app digital wallet, track order progress in real time, and reserve custom cakes for events. Canteen managers use SkipQ to handle incoming orders, manage their menu, and monitor business analytics. Platform admins oversee canteen registrations and user moderation.
The name "SkipQ" comes from "Skip the Queue." The goal is to save students from standing in long canteen lines by letting them order ahead of time and pick up their food when it is ready.

1.3 Key Features

- Browse menus from all campus canteens in one place
- Place orders and pay with a secure, PIN-protected digital wallet
- See estimated wait times before ordering
- Track your order status from placement to pickup
- Reserve custom cakes days in advance
- Rate dishes after pickup to help other students find the best food
- Canteen managers get a real-time dashboard for order processing
- Admins approve new canteen registrations and manage the platform

1.4 Who Is This For?

User Role	Who	What They Can Do
Customer (Student)	IIT Kanpur students with a valid @iitk.ac.in email	Browse menus, place orders, manage wallet, rate dishes, reserve cakes

User Role	Who	What They Can Do
Canteen Manager	Canteen operators (any valid email, requires admin approval)	Manage orders, update menus, view earnings and statistics, handle cake reservations
Administrator	Platform admins	Approve canteen and manager registrations

1.5 System Requirements

- **Device:** Any smartphone, tablet, laptop, or desktop
- **Browser:** Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Safari, or Microsoft Edge (latest version recommended)
- **Internet:** An active internet connection is required (no offline mode)
- **Email:** A valid @iitk.ac.in email address for student registration; any valid email for manager registration

1.6 Accessing SkipQ

Page	URL
Student / Manager Login	http://172.27.16.252:3000
Admin Login	http://172.27.16.252:3000/admin/login

1.7 Design and Theme

SkipQ uses a terracotta (#D4725C) colour scheme with a glass-morphism design style featuring translucent panels and floating card layouts. The app fully supports dark mode. The sun/moon toggle icon appears in the top-right corner of the header on every page. Your theme preference is saved locally in your browser. All currency is displayed in Indian Rupees (₹).

1.8 Important Notes

- **Pickup only.** SkipQ does not support delivery. You pick up your order from the canteen counter.
- **Wallet payments only.** All transactions go through the SkipQ Wallet. There is no cash or external UPI payment option.

- **Single-canteen cart.** Your cart can hold items from only one canteen at a time. Adding items from a different canteen will clear the existing cart (you will be warned before this happens).
- **Session-based login.** SkipQ uses browser cookies for authentication. If you clear your browser cookies, you will need to log in again. Check the "Remember Me" box during login to stay signed in for 31 days.

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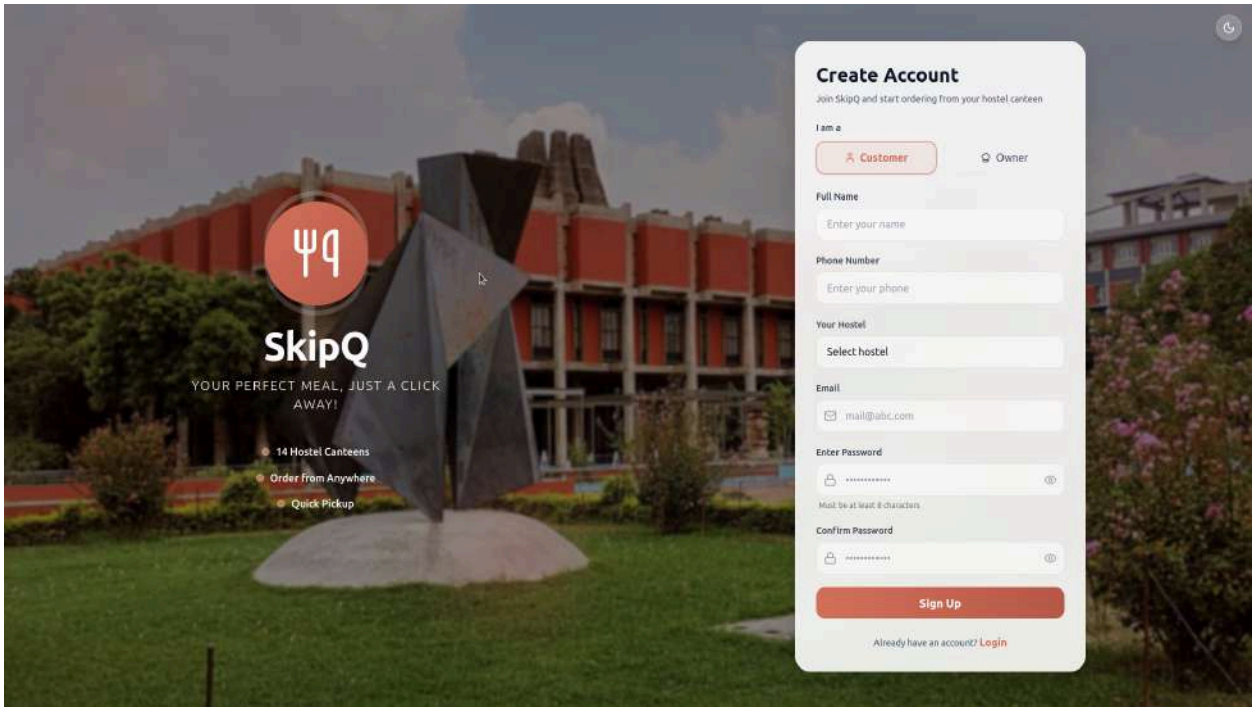
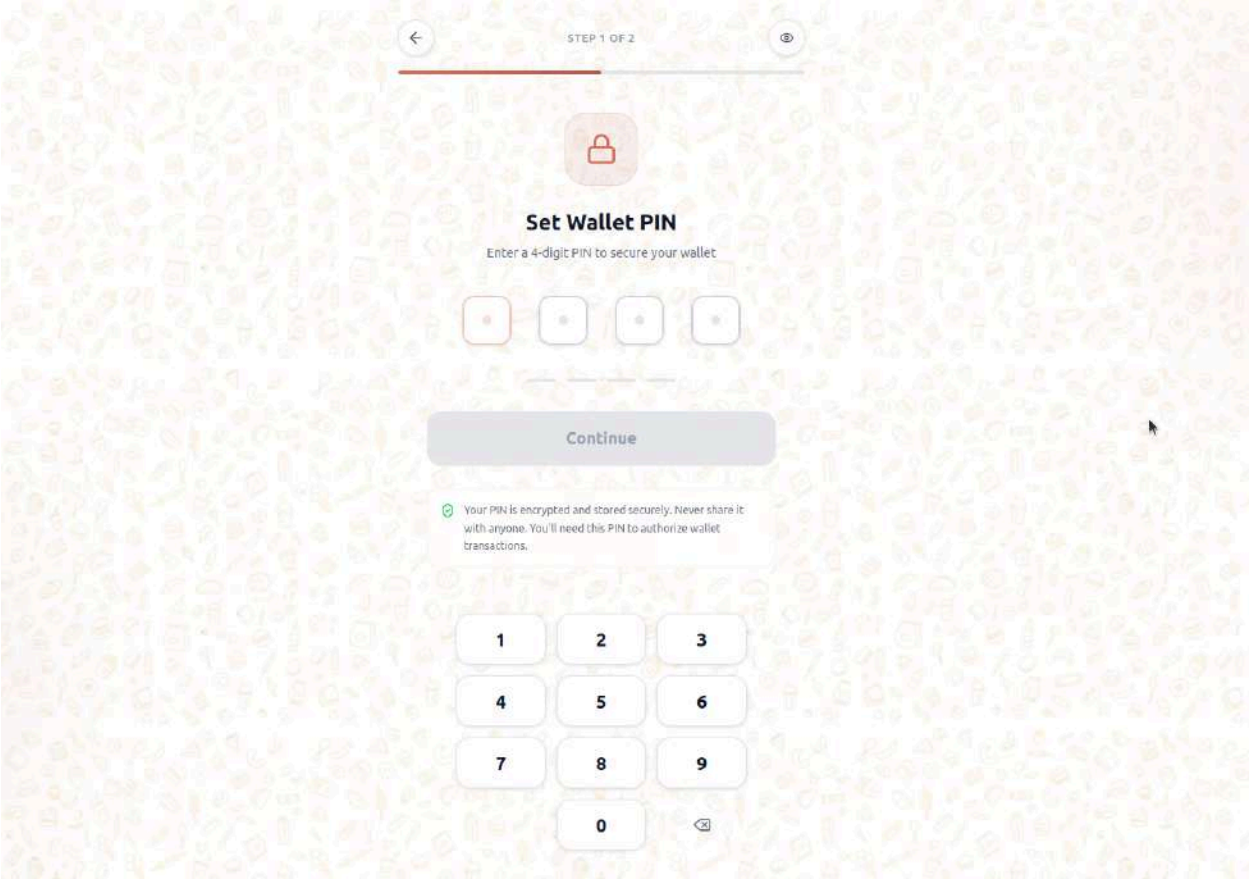
2. Getting Started

2.1 Creating a Student Account



1. Open SkipQ in your browser. You will see the **Unified Login** page.
2. Click the **Sign Up** tab.
3. 3. Fill in:
    - **Name:** Your full name.
    - **Email:** Your IIT Kanpur email (must end in @iitk.ac.in).
    - **Password:** Choose a strong password.
    - **Confirm Password:** Re-type the same password.
4. Click **Sign Up**.
5. A 6-digit OTP (One-Time Password) is sent to your email.
6. Enter the OTP on the verification screen.
7. On successful verification, your account is created and you are logged in automatically.
8. You will be redirected to the **Wallet PIN setup** page. This step is mandatory before you can place any orders.

2.2 Setting Your Wallet PIN (First Time)

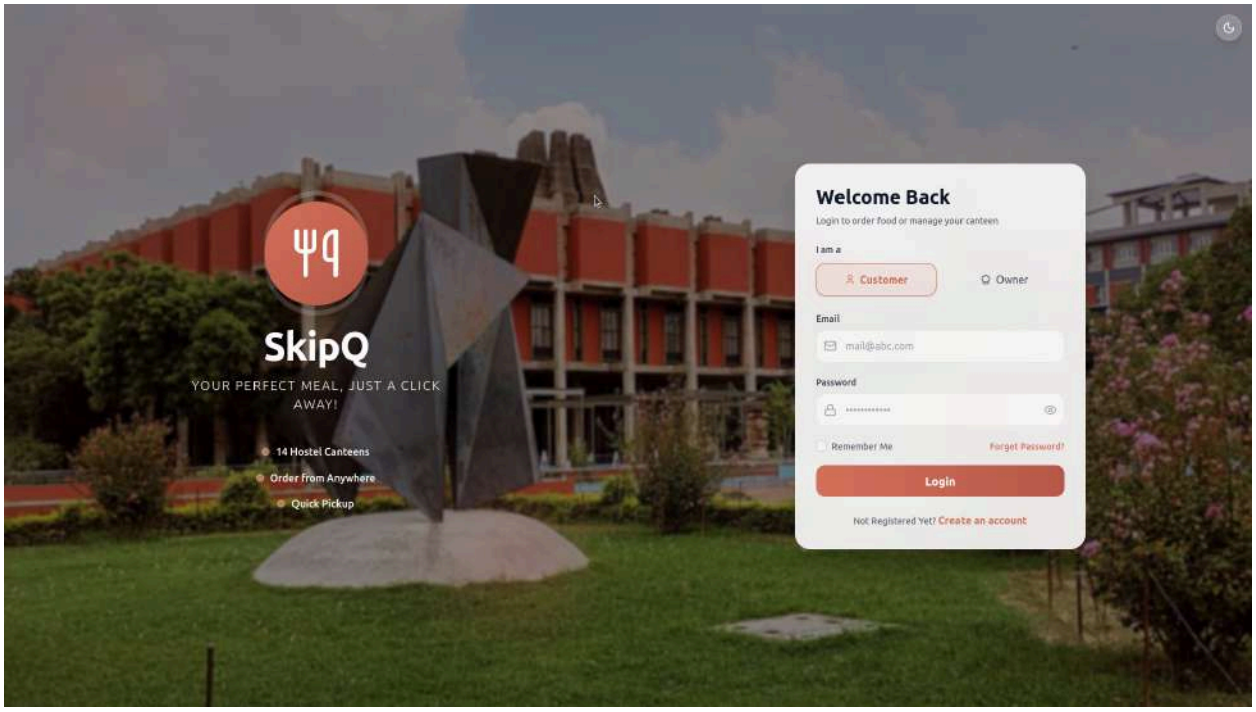


After registration, you must set a 4-digit numeric Wallet PIN. This PIN is required every time you place an order.

1. Enter a 4-digit numeric PIN.
2. Confirm the PIN.
3. Click **Set PIN**.

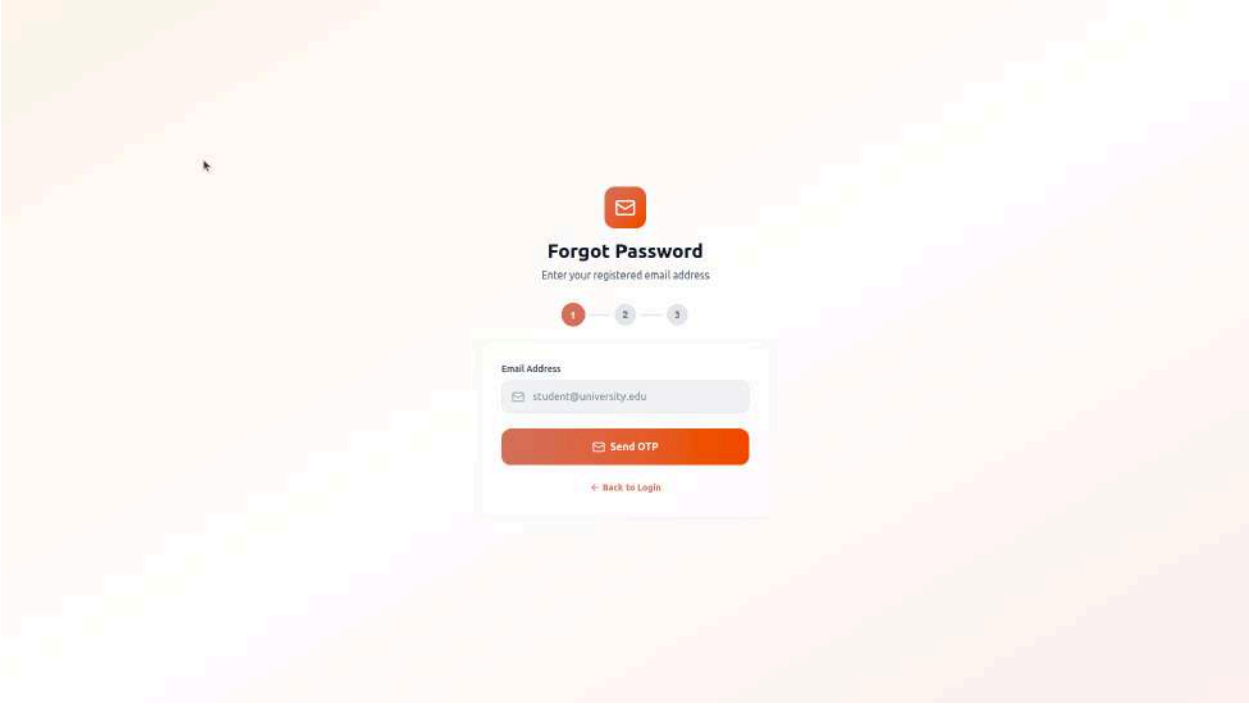
Your PIN is securely hashed and stored. Do not share your PIN with anyone.

2.3 Logging In



1. On the Unified Login page, switch to the **Login** tab.
2. Enter your email and password.
3. Optionally, check **Remember Me** to stay logged in for 31 days.
4. Click **Log In**.
5. You are redirected to the canteen selection page.

2.4 Forgot Password



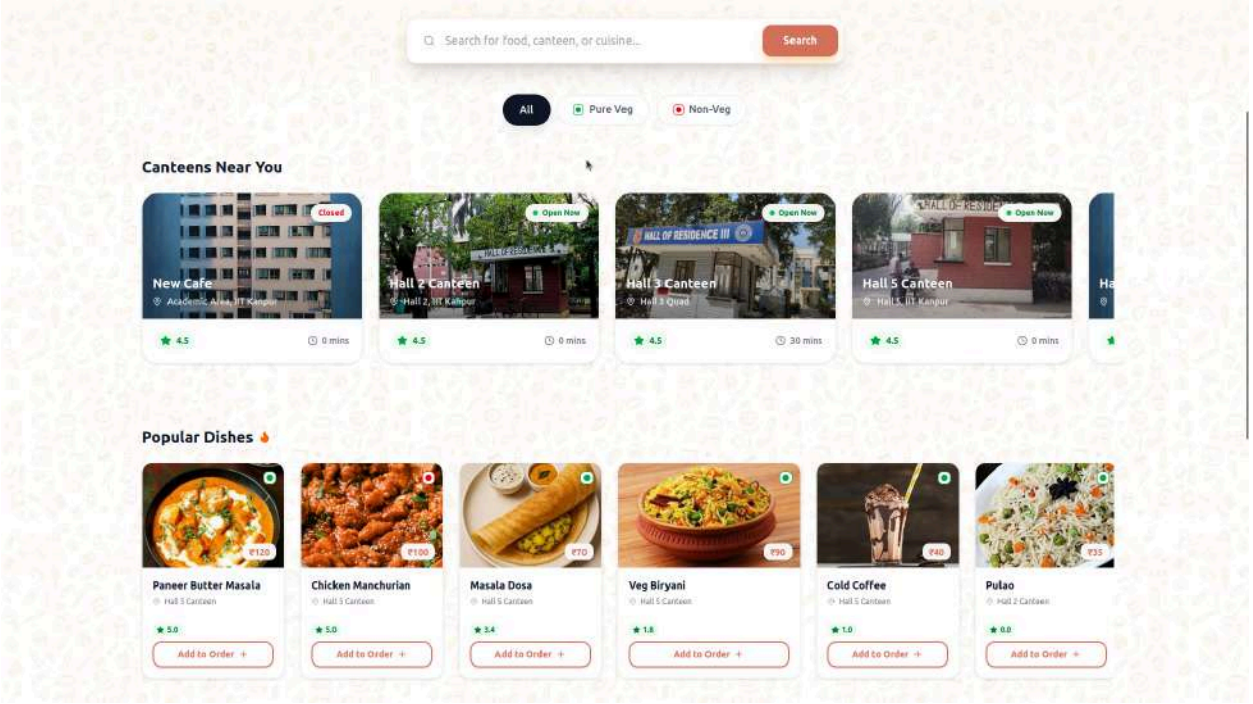
1. On the Login page, click **Forgot Password?**
2. Enter your registered email address.
3. An OTP is sent to your email. Enter it.
4. Set a new password and confirm it.
5. You can now log in with your new password.

2.5 Logging Out

Click on your profile or the navigation menu and select **Logout**. Your session is cleared and you are returned to the login screen.

3. Guide for Customers (Students)

3.1 Home Page — Browsing Canteens

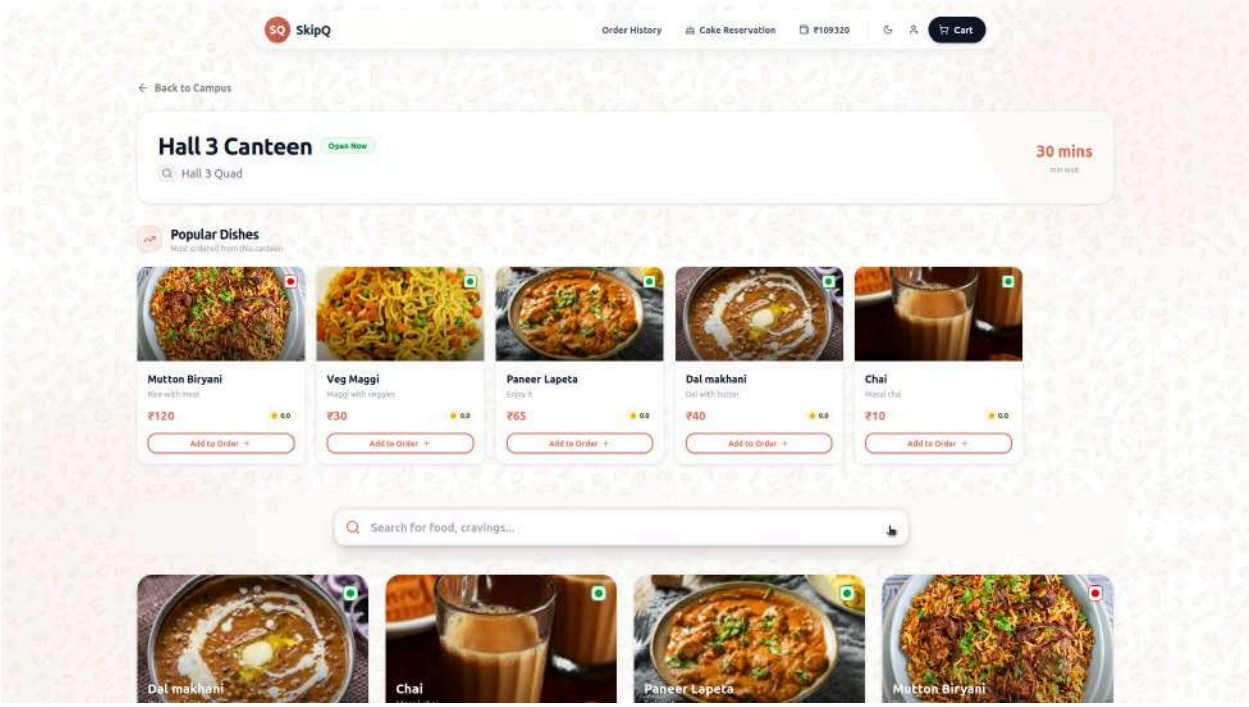


After logging in, you land on the **Canteen Selection** page. This is your home screen.

- **Canteen Cards:** Each card shows the canteen name, location, operational status (Open, Closed, or Busy), and estimated wait time.
- **Popular Dishes:** A horizontal carousel at the top or bottom displays popular dishes ranked by ratings across all canteens.
- **Dietary Filters:** Use the All, Veg, and Non-Veg toggle buttons to filter canteen listings.

Click on any canteen card to view its full menu.

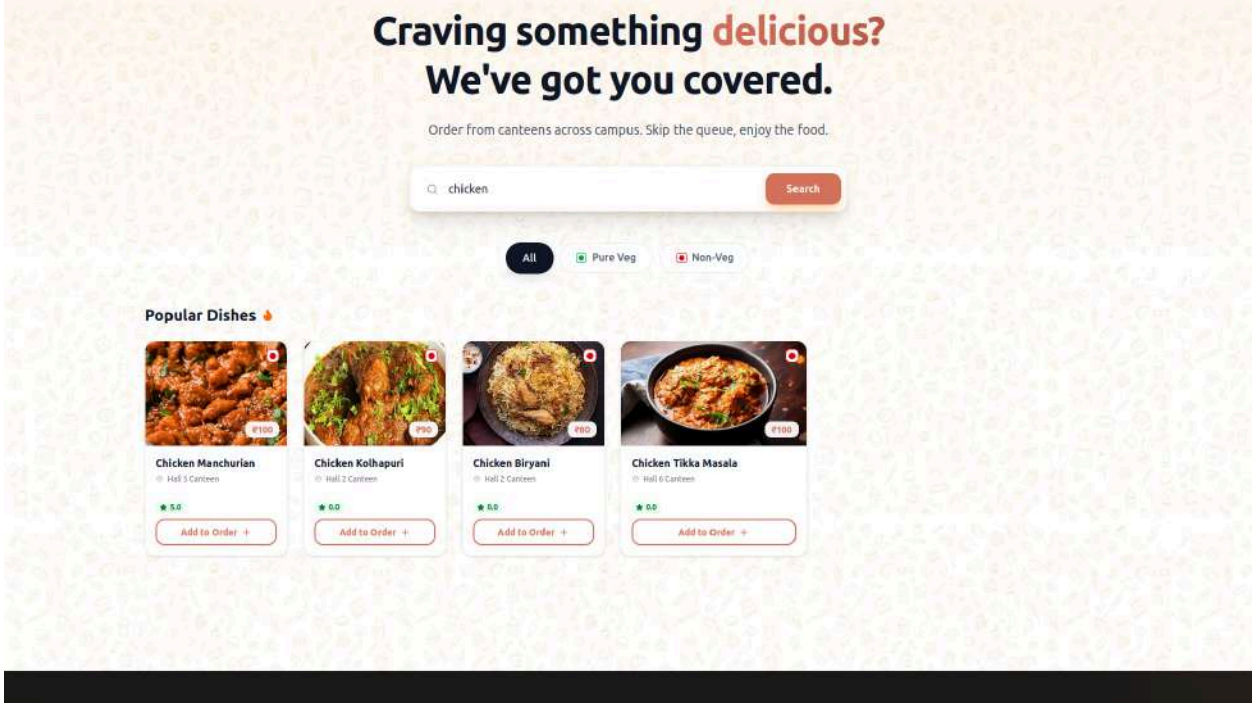
3.2 Browsing a Canteen Menu



On the menu page for a selected canteen:

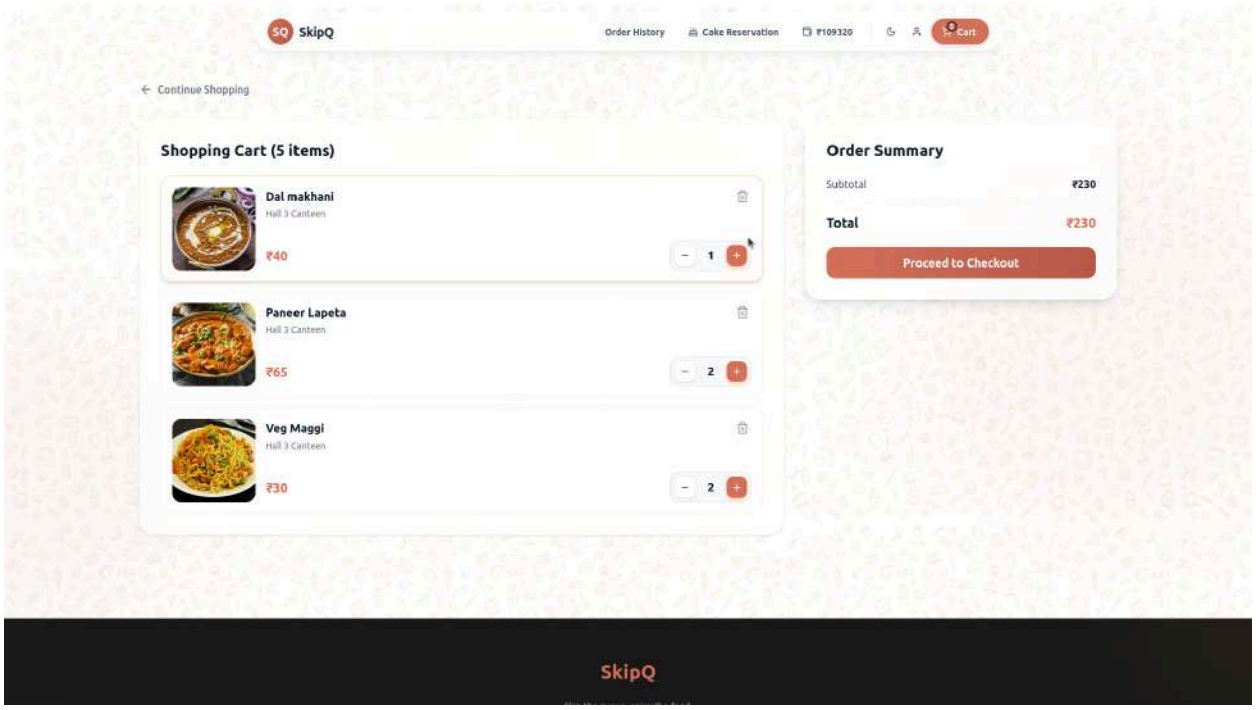
- **Category Tabs:** Filter dishes by category (Snacks, Beverages, Main Course, etc.).
- **Search Bar:** Type to search for specific dishes within this canteen.
- **Dish Cards:** Each card shows the dish name, price in ₹, photo (if available), veg/non-veg badge, star rating, and availability.
- **Add to Cart:** Click the + button to add a dish. Use the quantity controls (+/−) to adjust.

3.3 Searching Across All Canteens



Use the search icon in the header to search for food items across all canteens. Results display the dish name, which canteen it belongs to, the price, and an option to add it to your cart directly.

3.4 Reviewing Your Cart

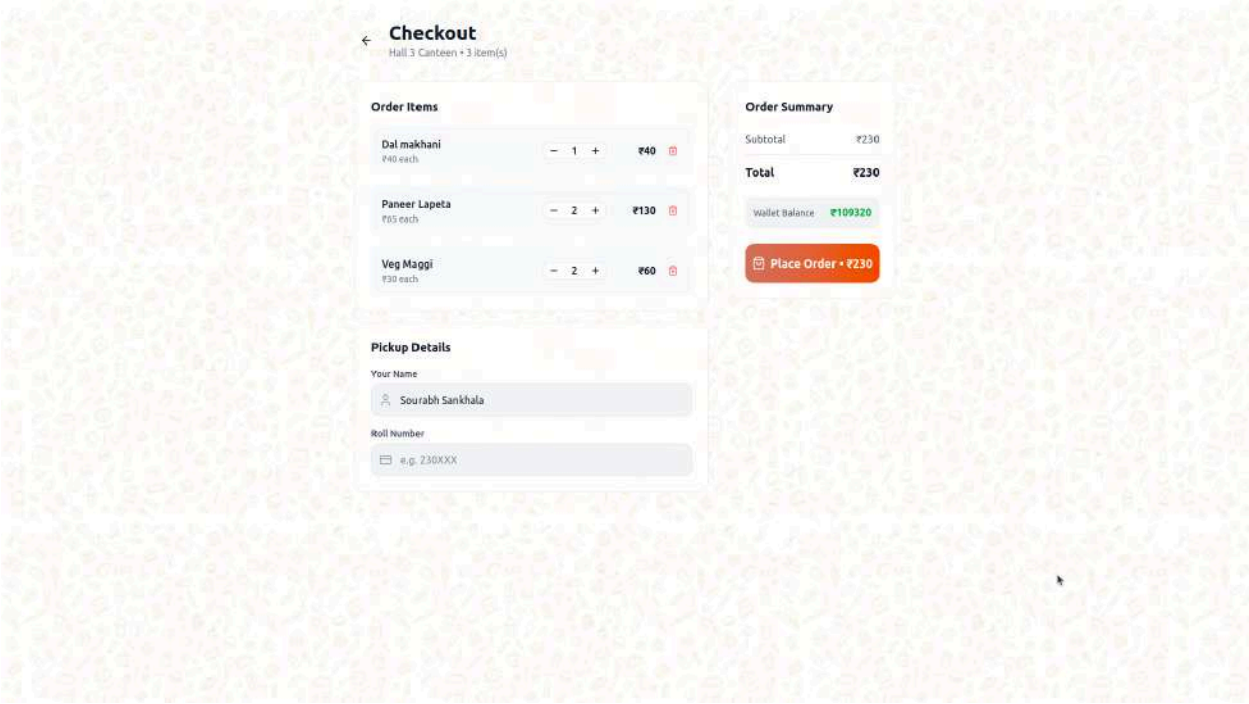


Click the cart icon in the navigation bar, or navigate to the full Cart page.
Here you can:

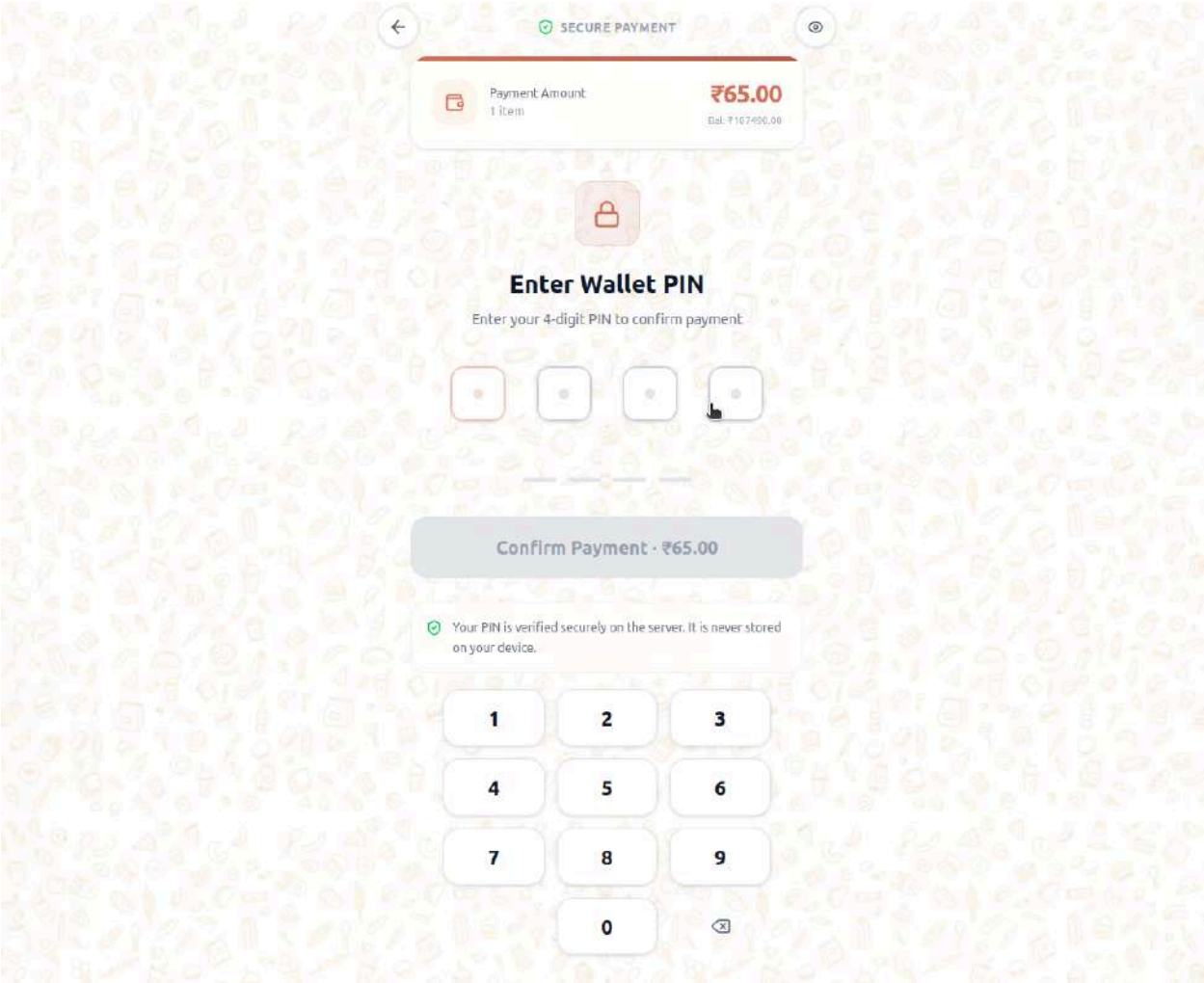
- See all items in your cart: dish name, quantity, price per item.
- Adjust quantities using + and − buttons.
- Remove individual items.
- See the total amount at the bottom.
- Clear the entire cart.

Remember: your cart can only contain items from one canteen at a time.

3.5 Checkout and Payment

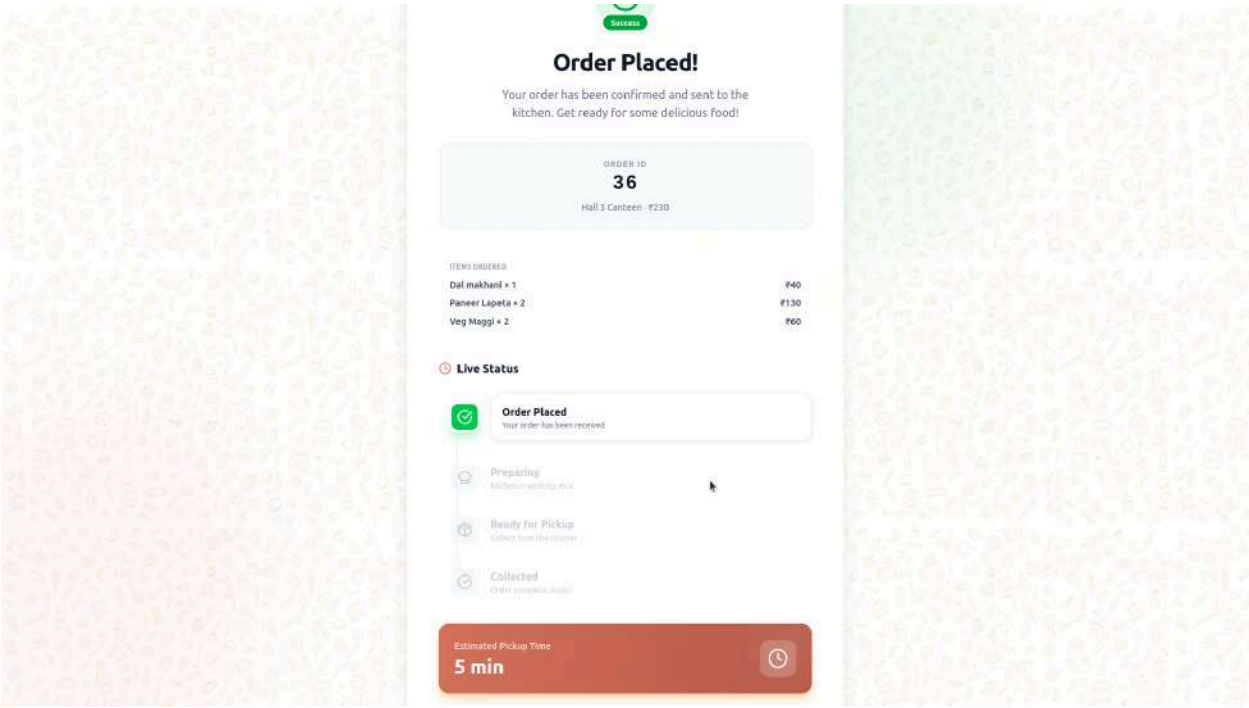


1. From the Cart, click **Proceed to Checkout**.
2. Enter your pickup details:
    - **Customer Name:** How the canteen will identify you at the counter.
    - **Roll Number:** Your IITK roll number.
    - **Special Instructions:** Any notes for the canteen (e.g., "less spicy"), optional.
3. Review the order summary and total.
4. Click **Place Order**.



5. You are prompted to enter your 4-digit **Wallet PIN**.
6. If the PIN is correct and your wallet has enough funds:
    - The total is deducted from your wallet.
    - The order is created with status **PENDING**.
    - The canteen manager is notified.
7. If the PIN is wrong or your balance is too low, the order is not placed and you see an error message.

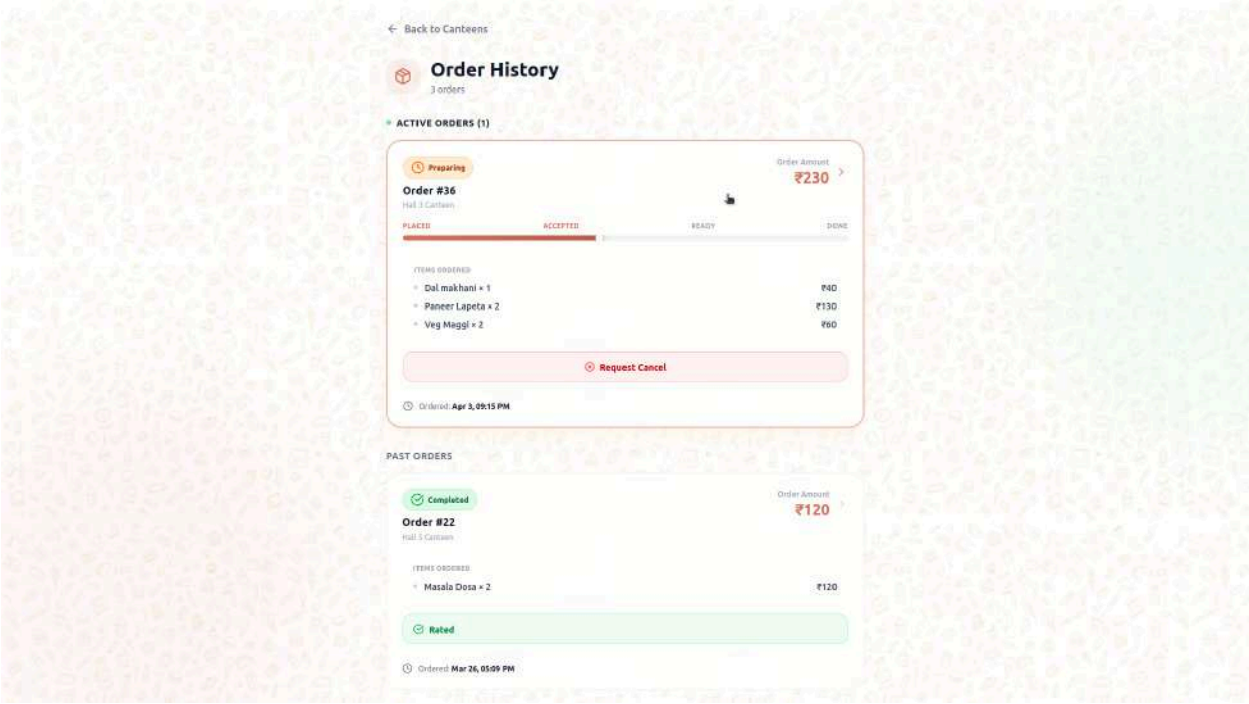
3.6 Order Confirmation



After a successful order, you land on the Order Confirmation page showing:

- Order ID
- Items ordered with quantities and individual prices
- Total amount paid
- Estimated wait time (calculated based on queue position)
- Current order status (starts as PENDING)

3.7 Tracking Your Orders



Navigate to **Track Orders** from the navigation menu. This page lists all your orders, newest first.

Order Status Flow

```
PENDING → ACCEPTED → READY → COMPLETED
```

Status	What It Means
PENDING	Waiting for the canteen manager to accept
ACCEPTED	Manager accepted; food is being prepared
READY	Food is ready; go to the canteen counter to pick it up
COMPLETED	You have picked up the order
REJECTED	Manager rejected the order; your wallet is automatically refunded
CANCEL_REQUESTED	You requested cancellation; waiting for the manager's decision

CANCELLED	Manager approved your cancellation; automatic refund

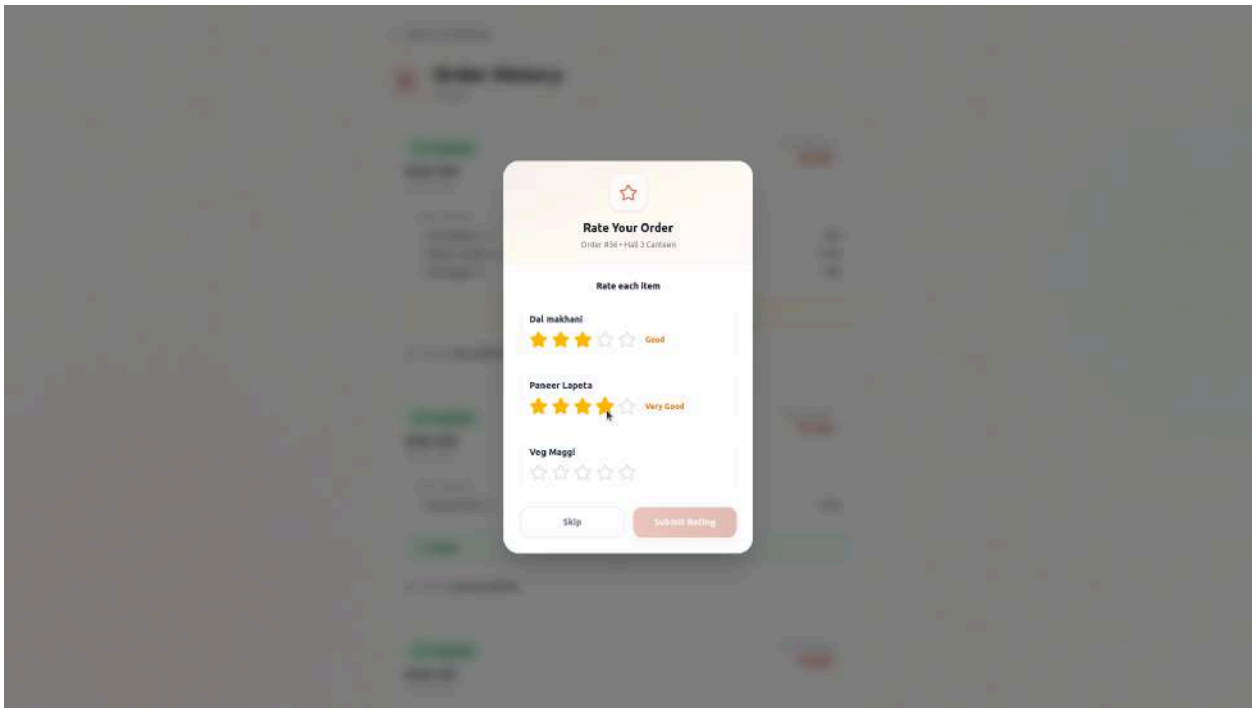
How to Cancel an Order

1. Find the order on the Track Orders page.
2. Click **Request Cancellation** (available for PENDING and ACCEPTED orders).
3. Your order status changes to CANCEL_REQUESTED.
4. The canteen manager will either approve or reject the cancellation.
    - If approved: the order is cancelled and you receive an automatic refund.
    - If rejected: the order reverts to its previous status and the manager may provide a reason.

Estimated Wait Time

Each order card shows a dynamic wait time. This is calculated based on the number of orders ahead of yours in the queue. Each order in the queue adds roughly 5 minutes. Once your order reaches READY or later, the wait time drops to 0.

3.8 Rating Dishes



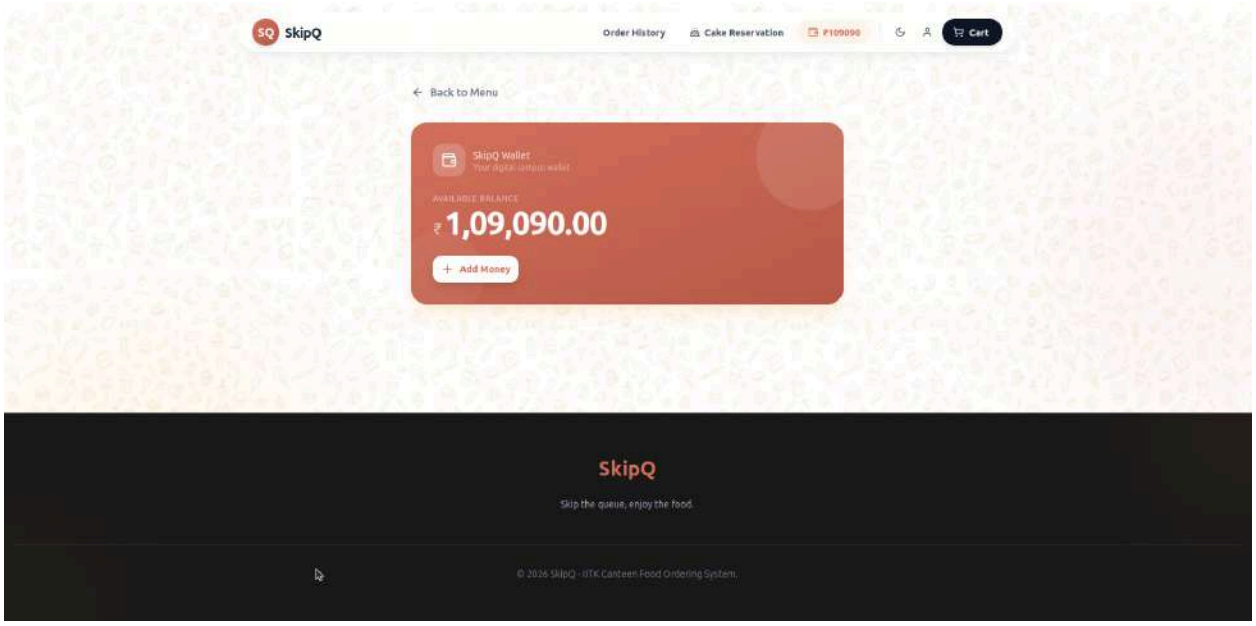
After an order reaches COMPLETED status, you can rate the individual dishes you ordered.

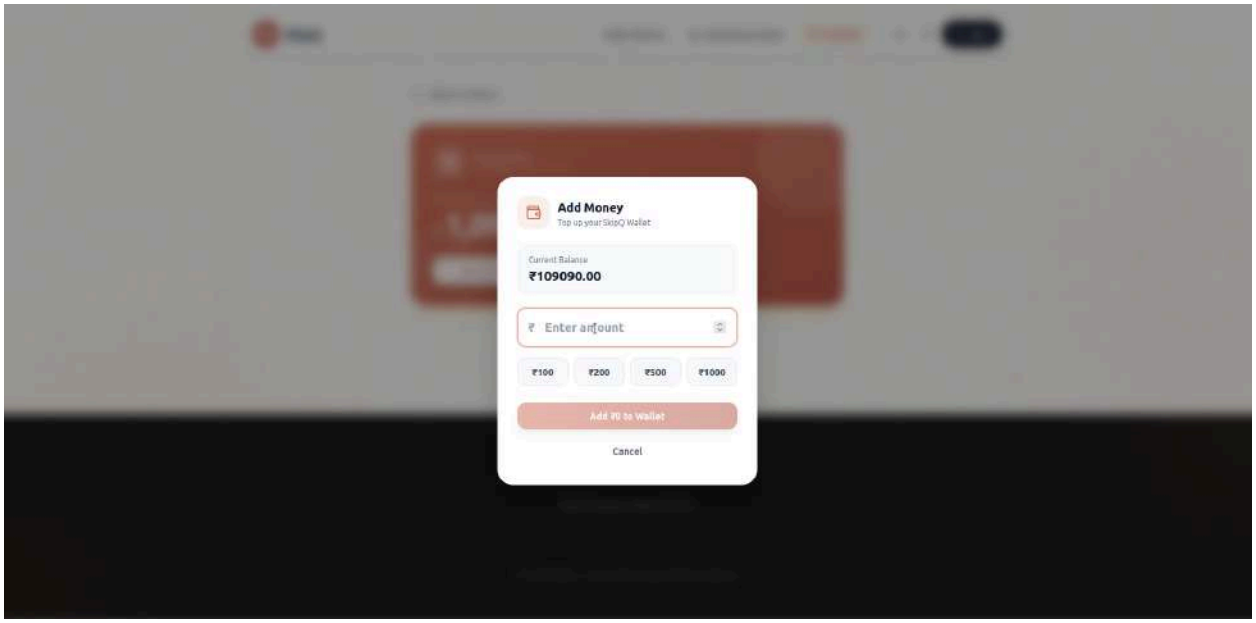
1. Go to Track Orders.
2. Find the completed order.
3. Click on a dish to rate it.
4. Select a rating from 1 to 5 stars.

5. Submit your rating.

Ratings are per-dish, per-order. You can only rate each dish once per order. There are no text reviews; the system is purely star-based.

3.9 Wallet Management





Navigate to **Wallet** from the navigation menu.

Viewing Your Balance

Your current wallet balance is displayed at the top of the page.

Adding Funds

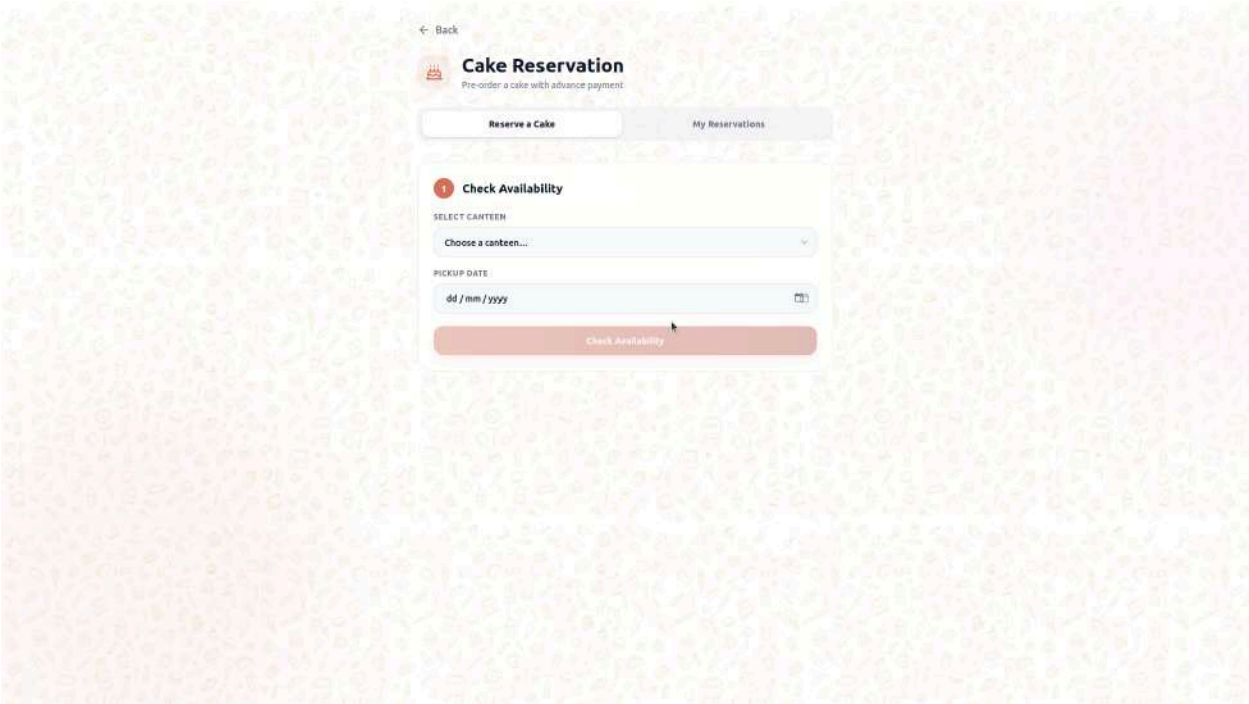
1. Enter the amount you want to add (in ₹).
2. Click **Add Money**.
3. The funds are credited to your wallet instantly.

Note: The current system simulates wallet top-up internally. In a production deployment, this would connect to an external payment gateway like Razorpay or UPI.

Changing Your Wallet PIN

Navigate to the Wallet PIN settings to update your 4-digit PIN at any time.

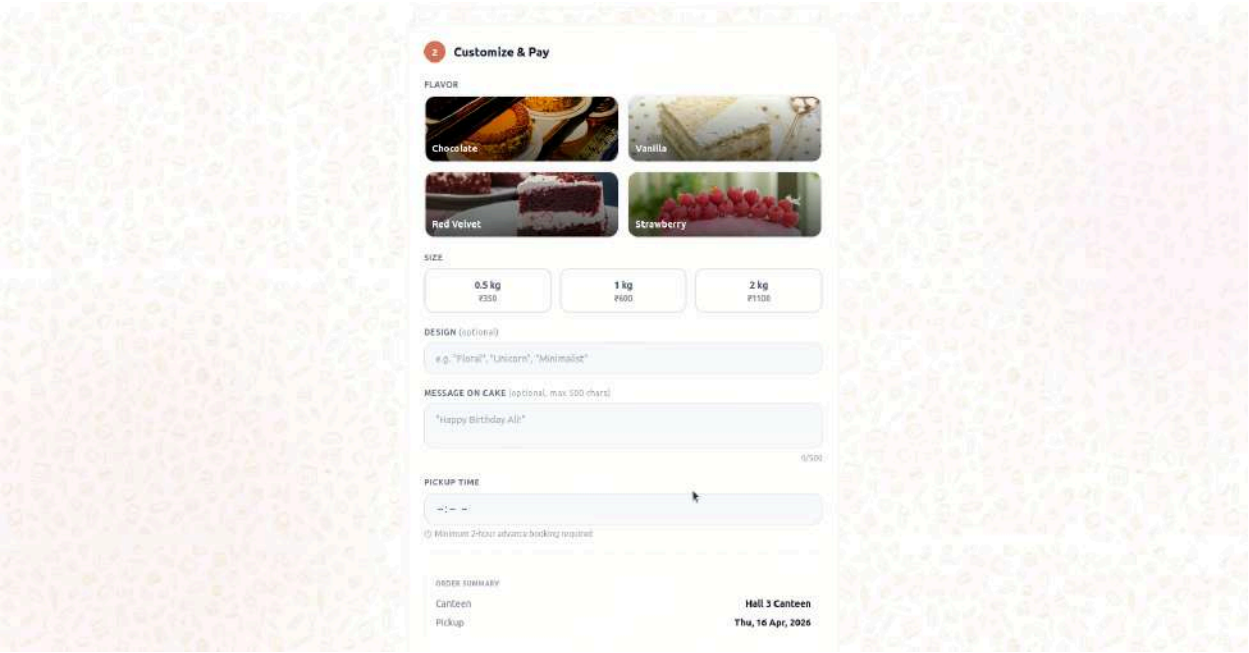
3.10 Cake Reservation



SkipQ offers a dedicated feature for reserving custom cakes for birthdays, events, and celebrations. The process is a multi-step wizard:

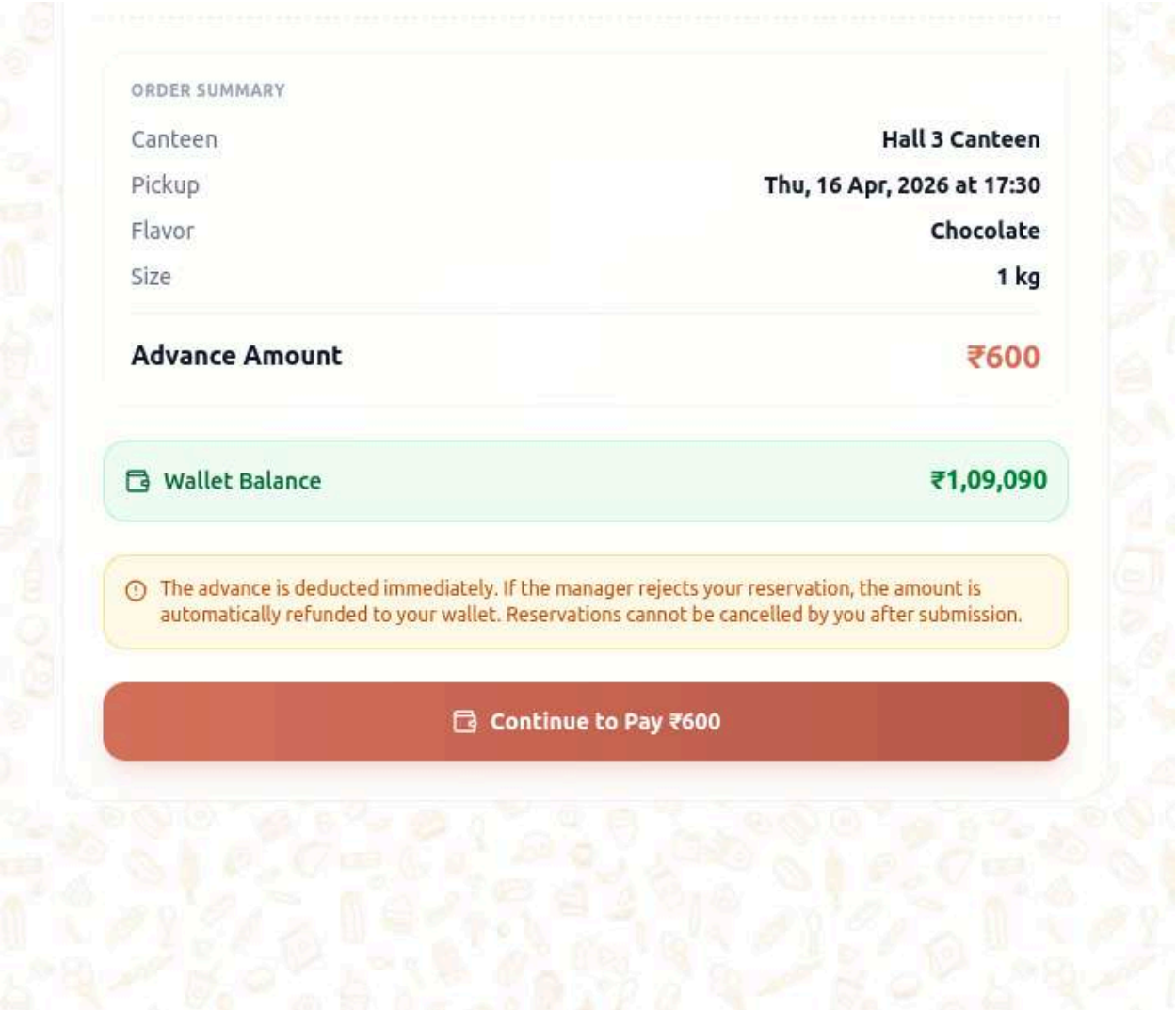
Step 1: Check Availability

1. Select a canteen.
2. Choose your desired pickup date.
3. The system checks whether the canteen is open on that date and whether the minimum lead time is met (default: 6 hours before pickup, configurable per canteen).
4. If available, proceed to the next step.



Step 2: Customise Your Cake

1. Select a flavour (e.g., Chocolate, Vanilla, Butterscotch).
2. Select a size (e.g., 0.5 kg, 1 kg, 2 kg).
3. Optionally add design details.
4. Optionally add a message for the cake (e.g., "Happy Birthday Rahul!").
5. Choose your preferred pickup time.



Step 3: Pay and Submit

1. Review the advance amount.
2. Enter your Wallet PIN to authorise payment.
3. Submit the reservation. Its status is now PENDING_APPROVAL.

Reservation Status Flow

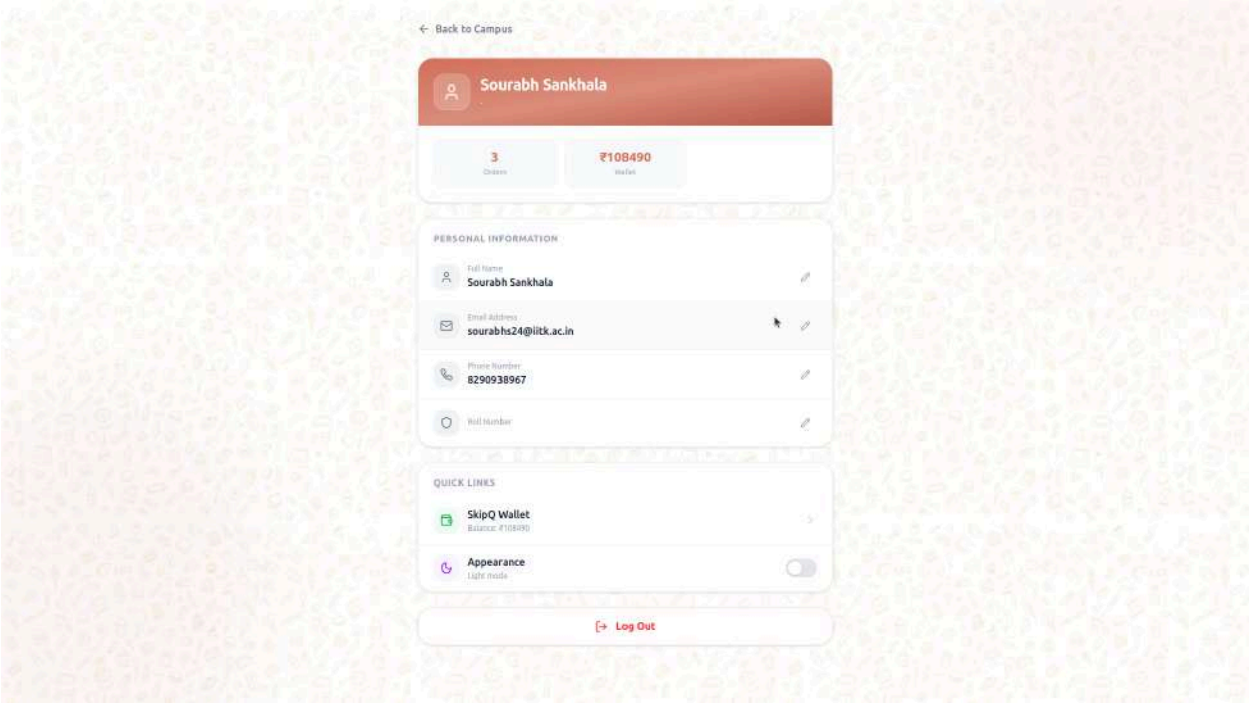
```
None
PENDING_APPROVAL → CONFIRMED → COMPLETED
                                          →
REJECTED → REFUNDED
```

Status	What It Means
PENDING_APPROVAL	Your reservation is submitted and paid; waiting for the manager
CONFIRMED	Manager accepted your reservation
REJECTED	Manager rejected your reservation; you get an automatic refund
COMPLETED	You picked up the cake

Viewing Your Reservations

Navigate to the Cake Reservation page to see all your past and current reservations, including the status of each one and (if rejected) the reason.

3.11 Profile Management



Navigate to **Profile** from the navigation menu.

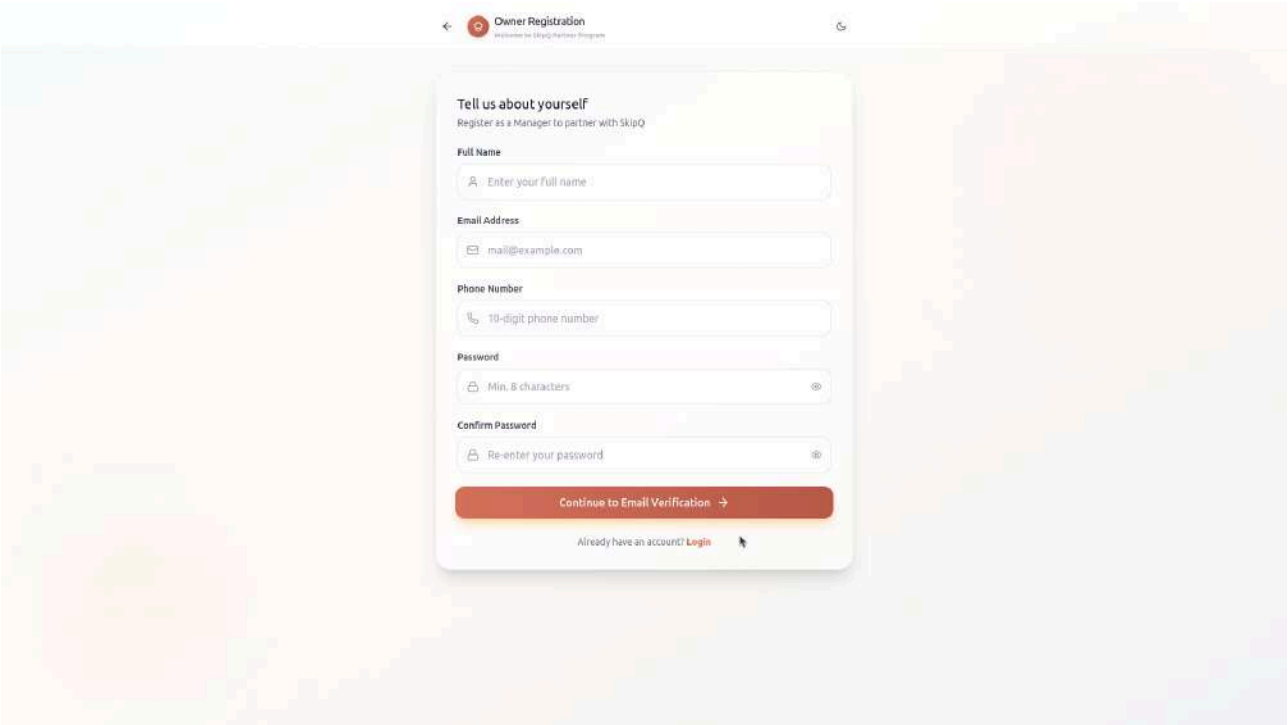
- Your profile banner shows your name and email.
- You can edit your **Name** and **Phone Number**.
- Your **Email** cannot be changed (it is tied to your account identity).
- Use the **Dark Mode toggle** (sun/moon icon) to switch between light and dark themes. Your preference is saved locally.

4. Guide for Canteen Managers

4.1 Manager Registration (Two-Step Process)

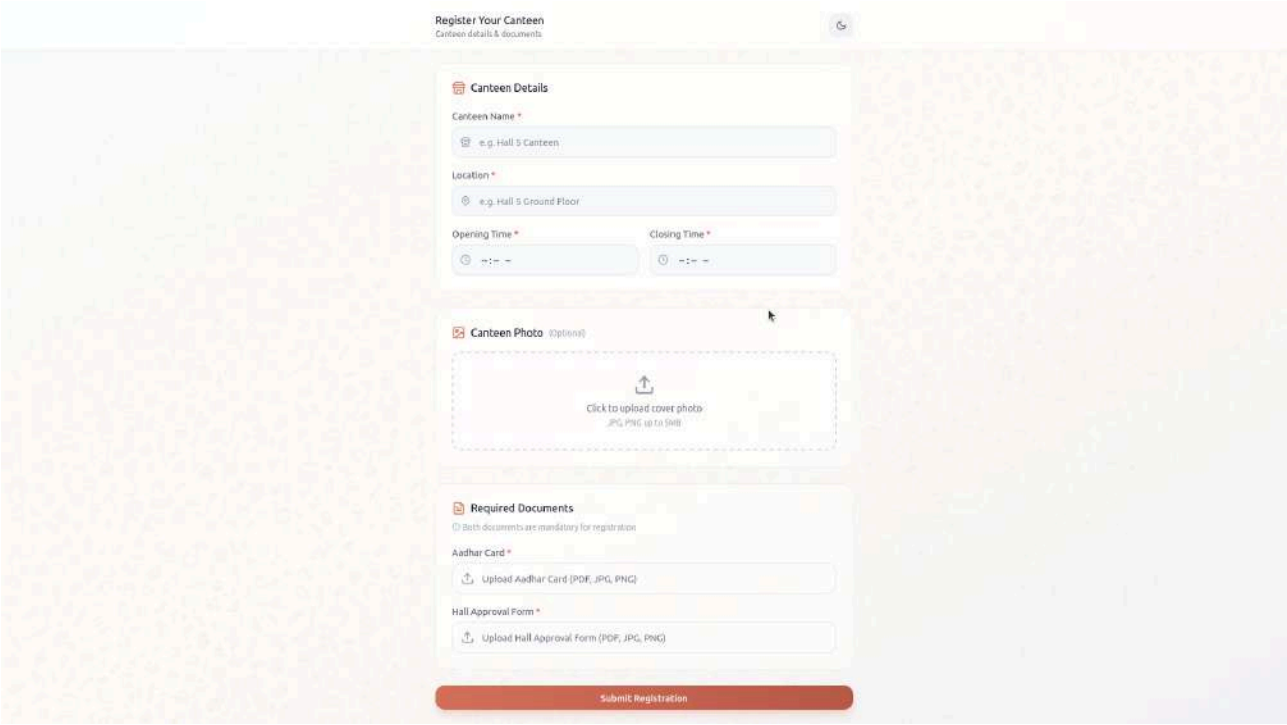
Manager registration requires admin approval. It is not instant like student registration.

Step 1: Personal Registration



1. Navigate to the **Owner Registration** page.
2. Fill in your personal details: Name, Email (any valid email), Password, Confirm Password.
3. Submit. An OTP is sent to your email.
4. Verify the OTP.
5. A pending manager registration record is created.

Step 2: Canteen Registration

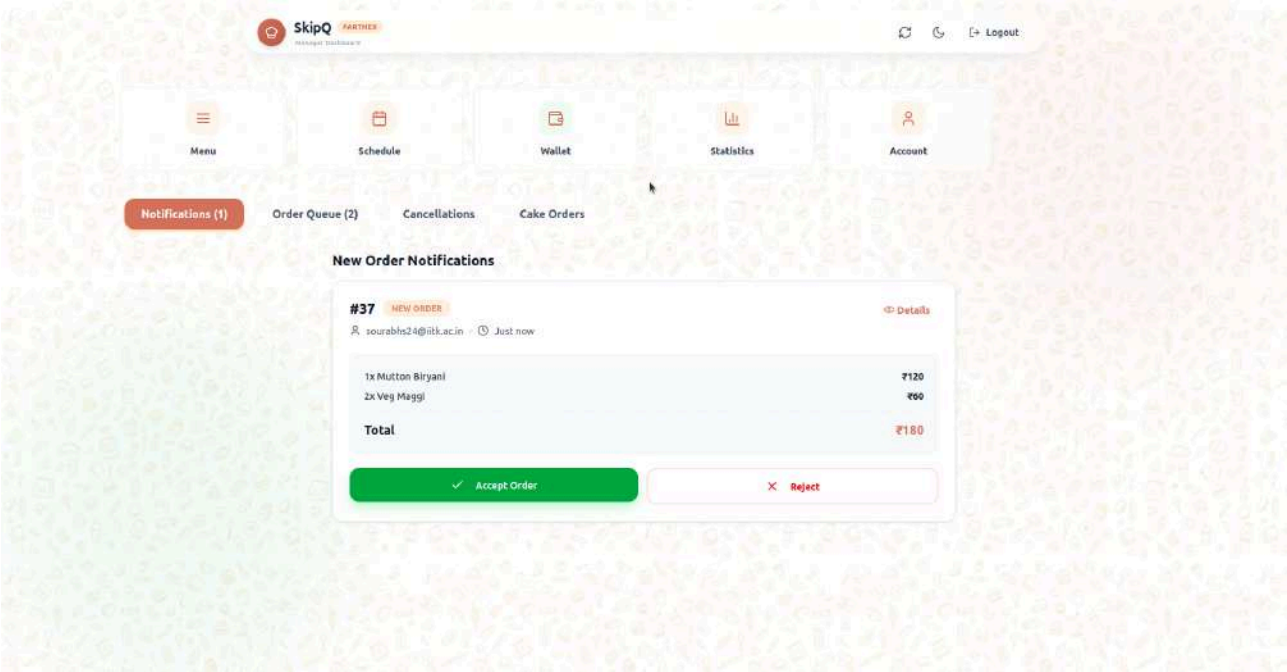


1. After your personal registration is approved, navigate to the **Canteen Registration** page
2. Fill in your canteen details:
    - Canteen Name
    - Location
    - Opening Time and Closing Time
    - Upload your Aadhaar card (for identity verification)
    - Upload your Hall Approval Form (for authorisation)
3. Submit for admin review.

Step 3: Waiting for Admin Approval

- An admin reviews your registration and uploaded documents.
- If **approved:** Your user account and canteen are both activated. You can now log in and start managing orders.
- If **rejected:** You receive a notification with the rejection reason. No account is created.

4.2 Manager Dashboard

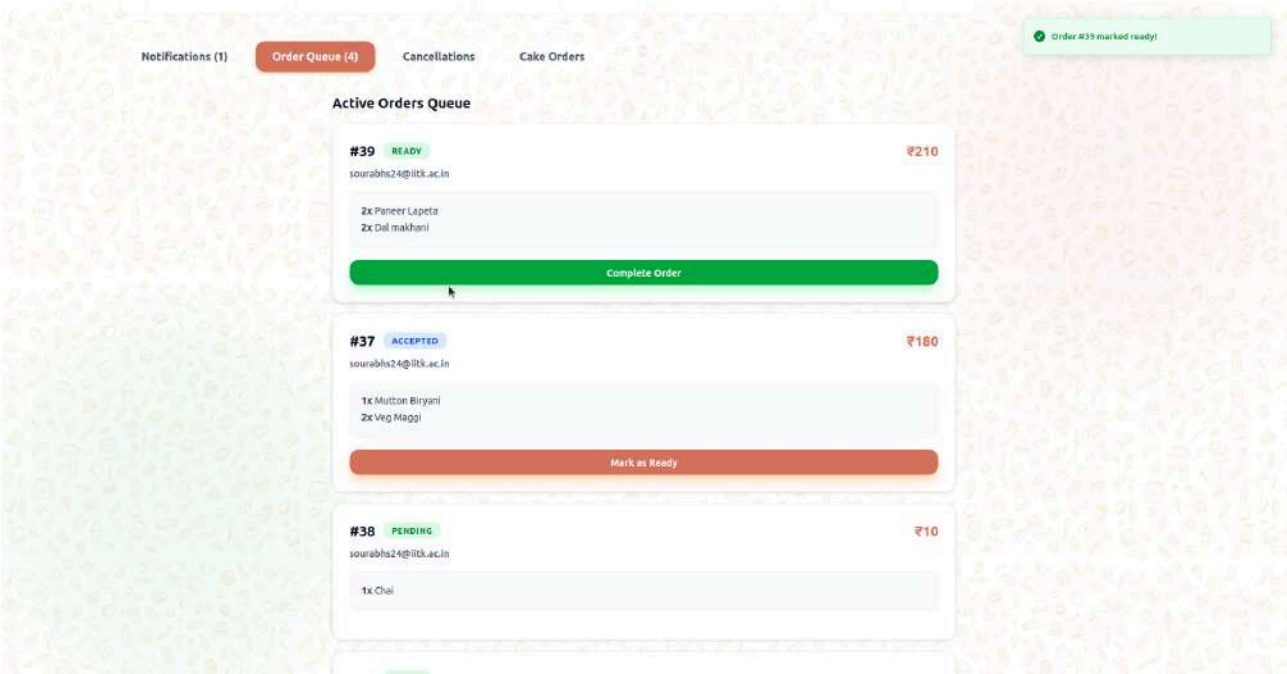


After logging in, managers land on the **Owner Dashboard**. It has four tabs:

Tab 1: Notifications

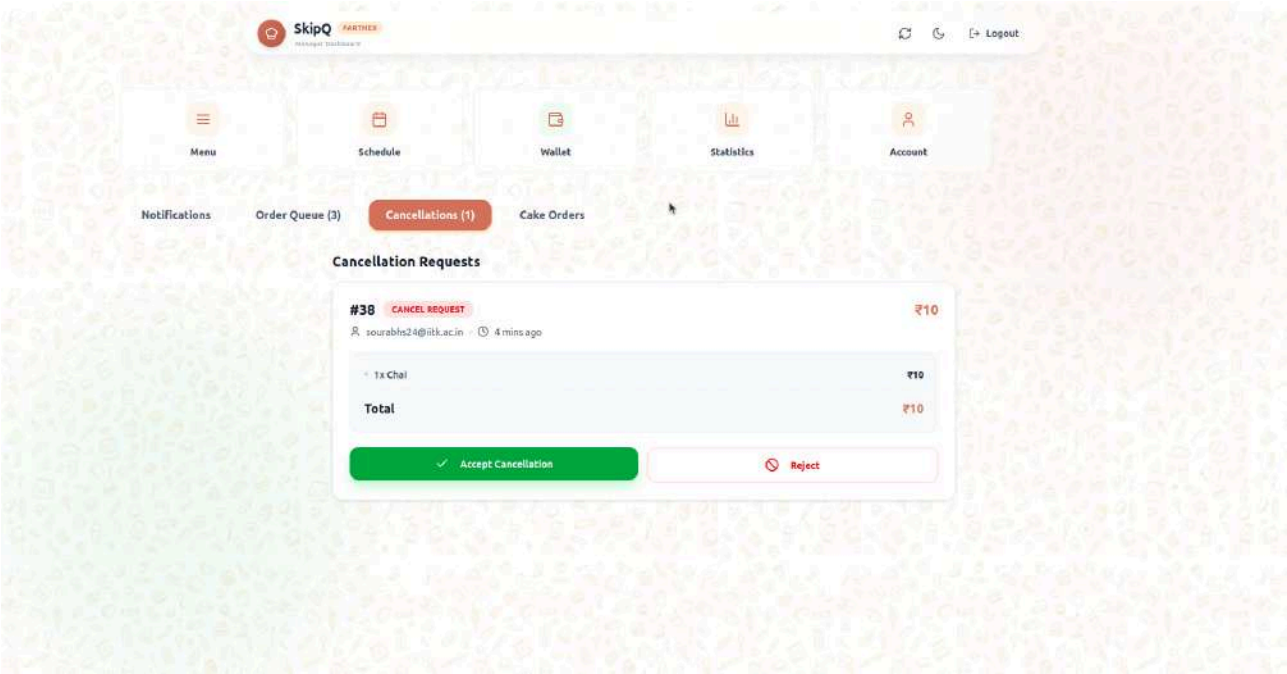
- Shows new incoming order alerts.
- Quick-action buttons to accept or reject orders directly from here.

Tab 2: Order Queue



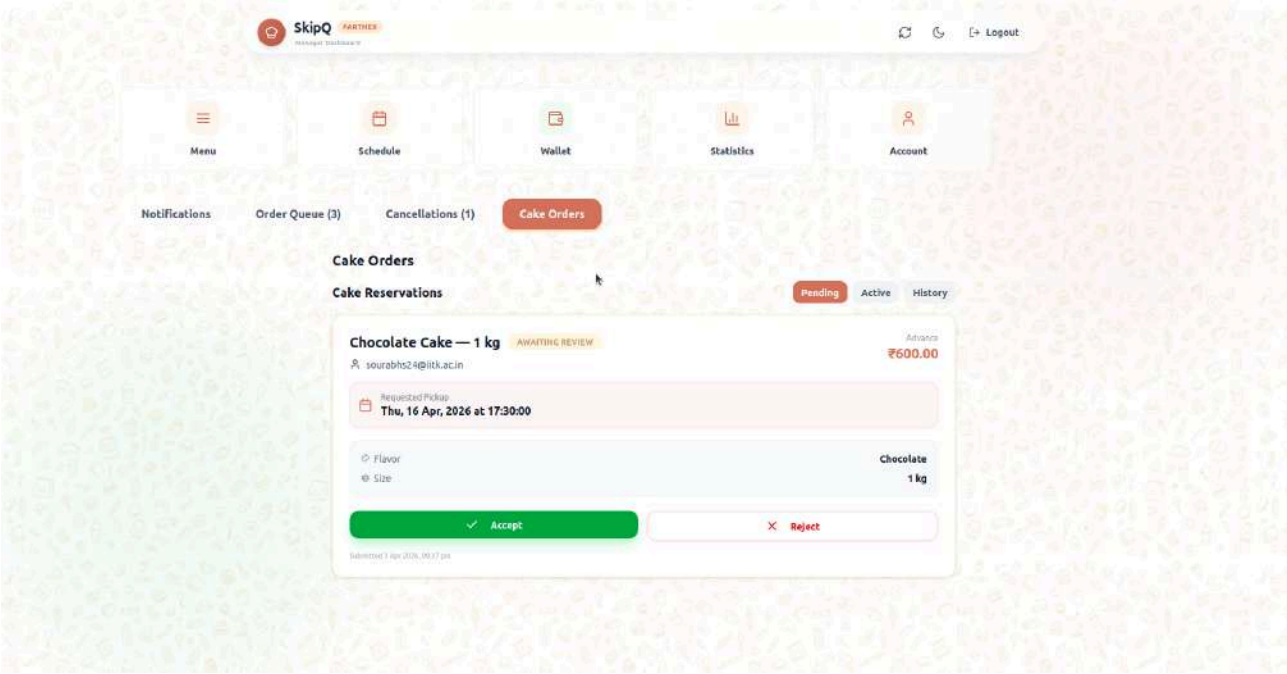
- Lists all active orders grouped by status: PENDING, ACCEPTED, READY.
- Each order card shows:
  - Order ID, timestamp
  - Customer name and roll number
  - Items ordered with quantities
  - Total amount
  - Special instructions (if any)
- **Actions available:**
  - **Accept** (PENDING → ACCEPTED): Start preparing the order.
  - **Reject** (PENDING → REJECTED): Reject with a reason. The customer gets an automatic refund.
  - **Mark Ready** (ACCEPTED → READY): Food is prepared; customers can come pick it up.
  - **Mark Complete** (READY → COMPLETED): The customer has picked up their order. The order amount is credited to your (the manager's) wallet.

Tab 3: Cancellations



- Shows cancellation requests from customers.
- **Approve Cancellation:** Order becomes CANCELLED, the customer gets a refund.
- **Reject Cancellation:** Order reverts to its previous status. You can optionally provide a reason.

Tab 4: Cake Requests



- Shows all cake reservation requests for your canteen.

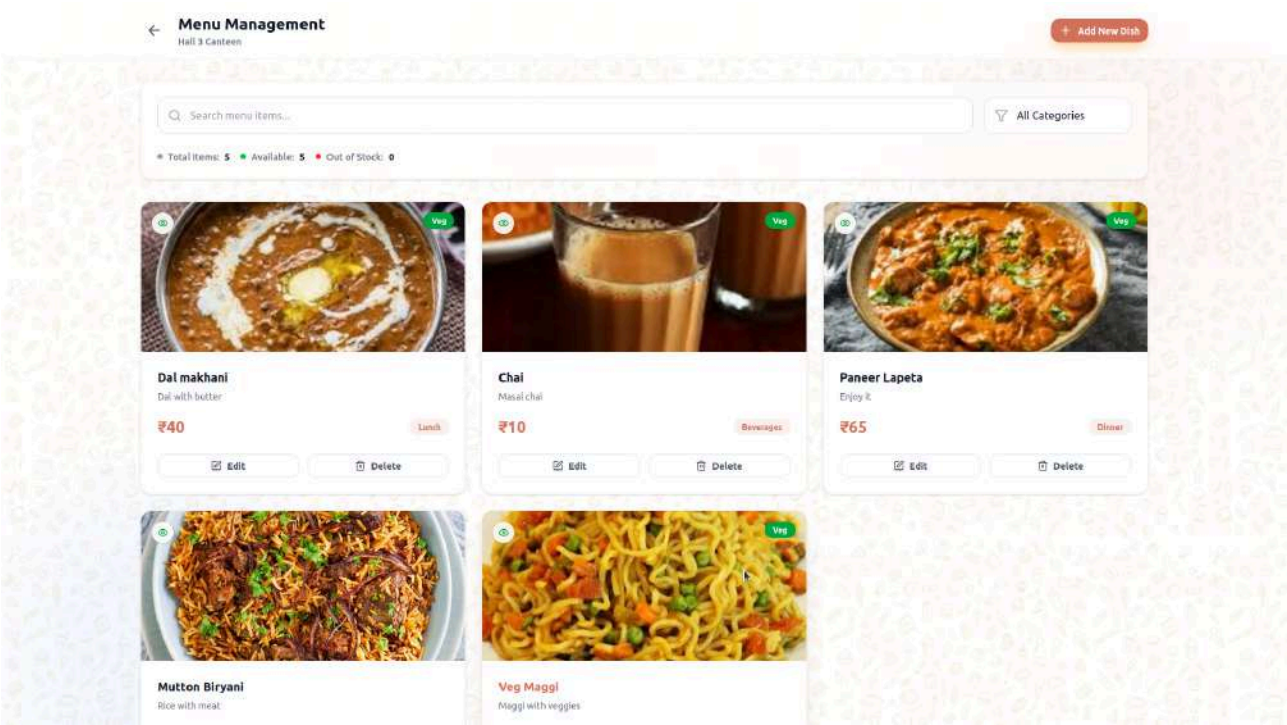
- A badge shows the count of pending requests.
- **Accept:** You commit to making the cake. Status moves to CONFIRMED.
- **Reject:** Provide a reason. The customer gets an automatic refund.
- **Complete:** Mark the cake as picked up.

Quick Action Buttons

The dashboard also has quick-access buttons to jump to:

- **Menu** (Menu Management)
- **Schedule** (Schedule Management)
- **Account** (Owner Account)
- **Cakes** (Cake Management page, with badge showing pending count)

4.3 Menu Management



Navigate to **Menu** from the dashboard or sidebar.

Adding a New Dish

1. Click **Add New Dish**.
2. Fill in:
    - **Dish Name** (required)
    - **Price** in ₹ (required)
    - **Category** (e.g., Snacks, Beverages, Main Course)
    - **Veg / Non-Veg** toggle
    - **Description** (optional)

- **Image** (optional; uploaded images are automatically converted to JPEG)

3. Click **Save**. The dish appears in your menu immediately.

Editing a Dish

- Click the edit icon on a dish card.
- Modify any field: name, price, category, description, veg/non-veg type, or image.
- Save changes.

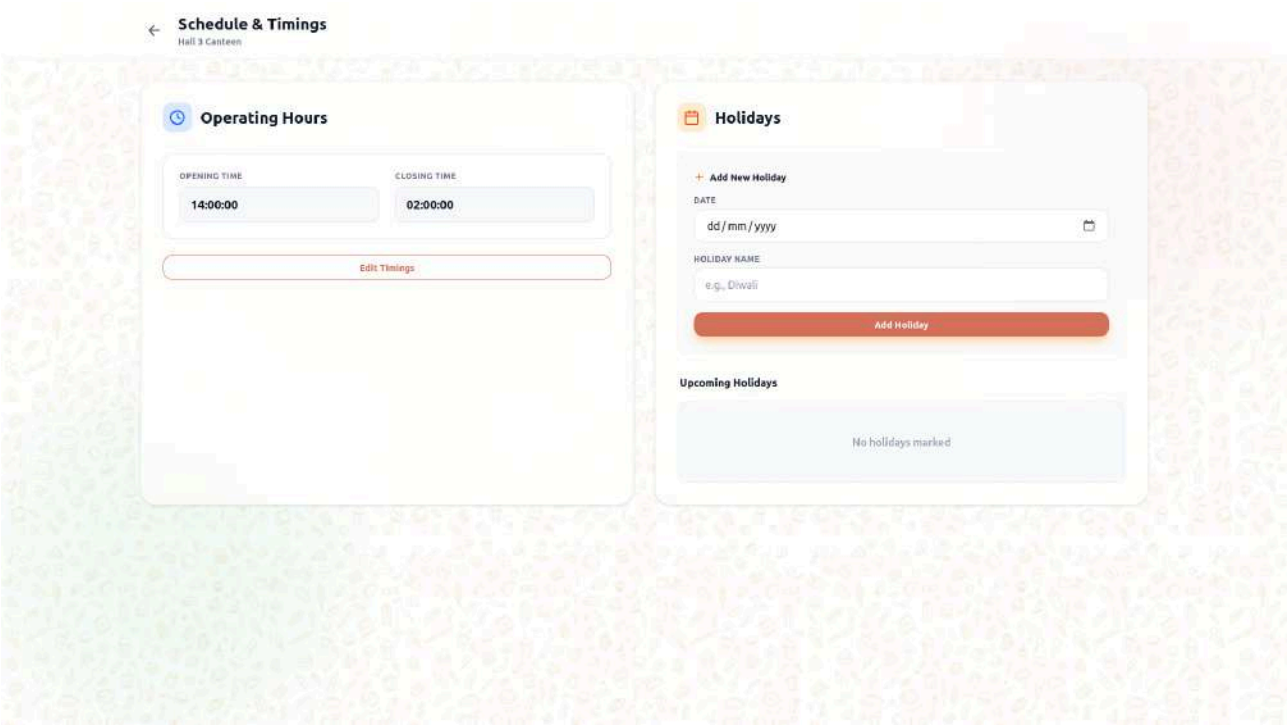
Toggling Dish Availability

- Click the availability toggle on any dish.
- When toggled off, the dish shows as "Out of Stock" and customers cannot order it.
- Toggle it back on when the dish is available again.

Deleting a Dish

- Click the delete icon on a dish card.
- Confirm deletion. The dish is permanently removed from the menu.

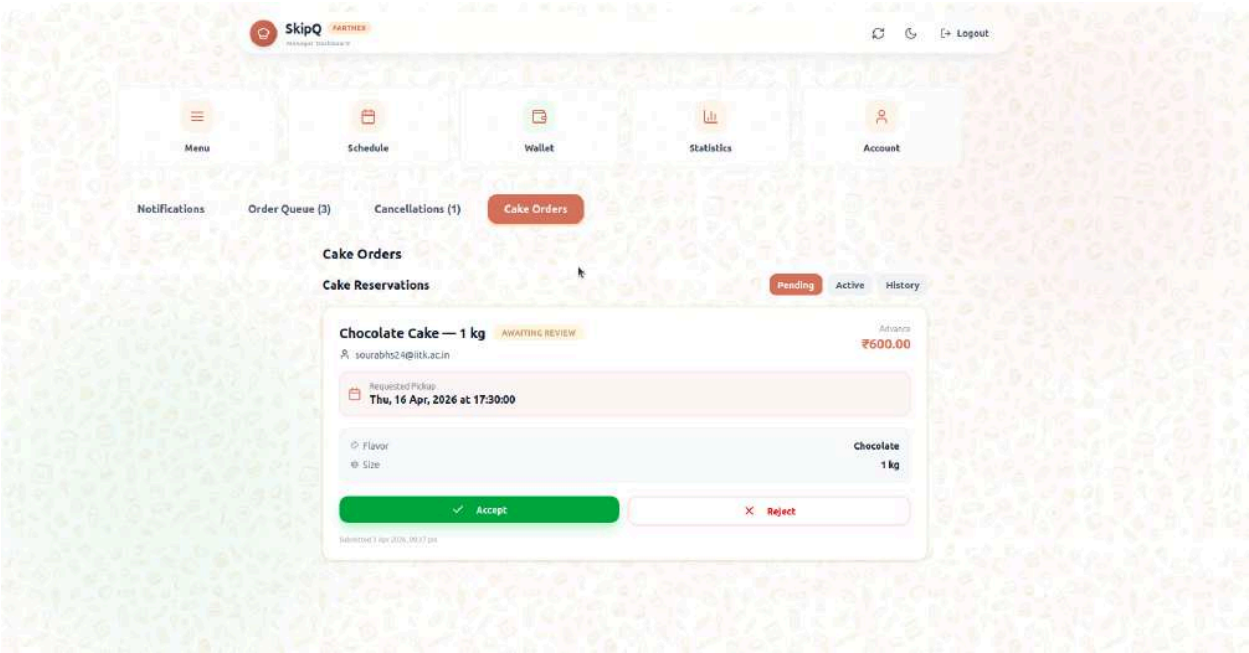
4.4 Schedule Management



Navigate to **Schedule** from the dashboard.

- View and update your canteen's operating hours (opening time and closing time).
- Changes are reflected immediately to customers browsing canteens.

4.5 Cake Management



Navigate to **Cakes** from the dashboard or sidebar.

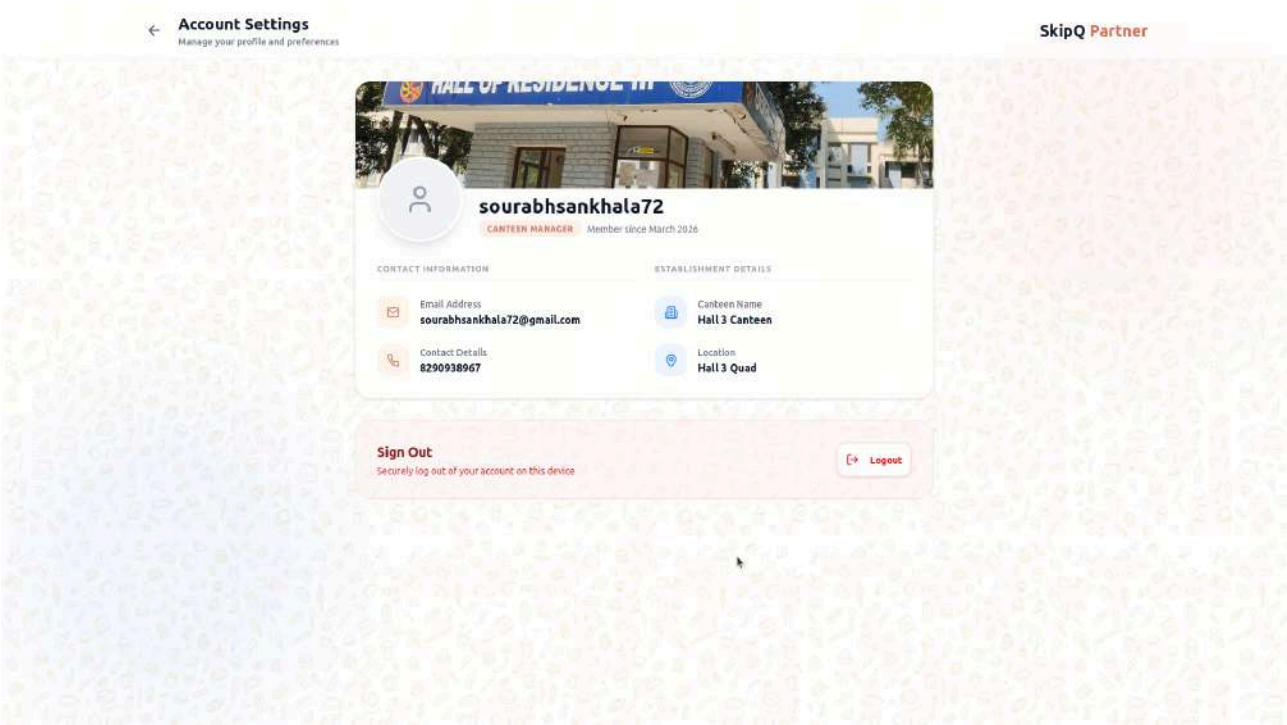
- View all cake reservations for your canteen.
- Filter by status: Pending, Confirmed, Completed, Rejected.
- Each reservation card shows: customer name, flavour, size, design, message, pickup date/time, advance amount, and status.
- Actions: Accept, Reject (with reason), or Complete.

4.6 Statistics

Navigate to **Statistics** from the dashboard.
View analytics for your canteen, including:

- Total orders and revenue (monthly breakdown)
- Most frequently ordered dishes
- Revenue per dish statistics

4.7 Owner Account

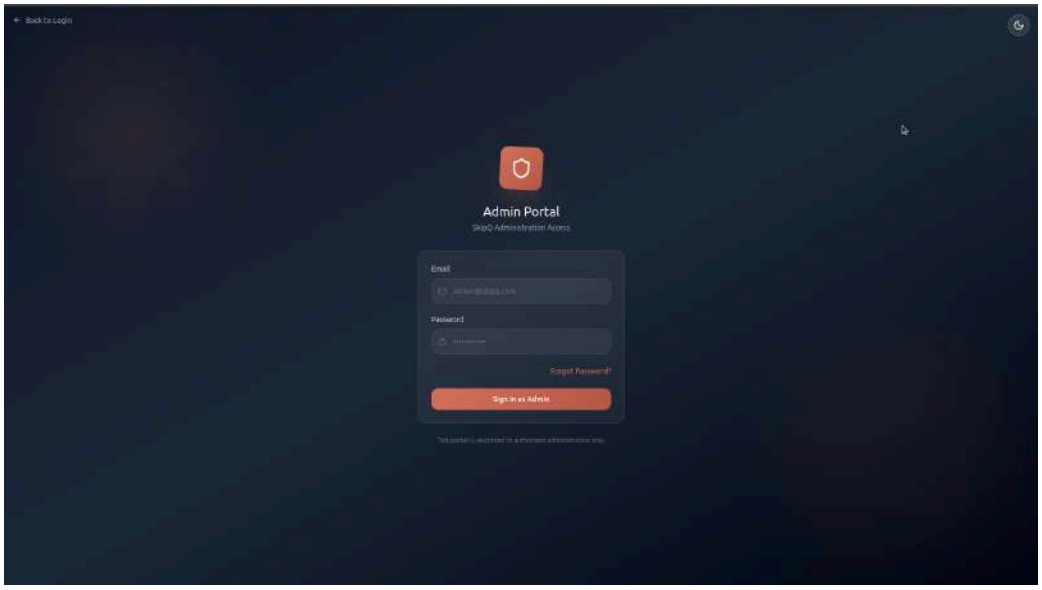


Navigate to **Account** from the dashboard.

- View and edit your profile information (name, phone).
- Change your password.

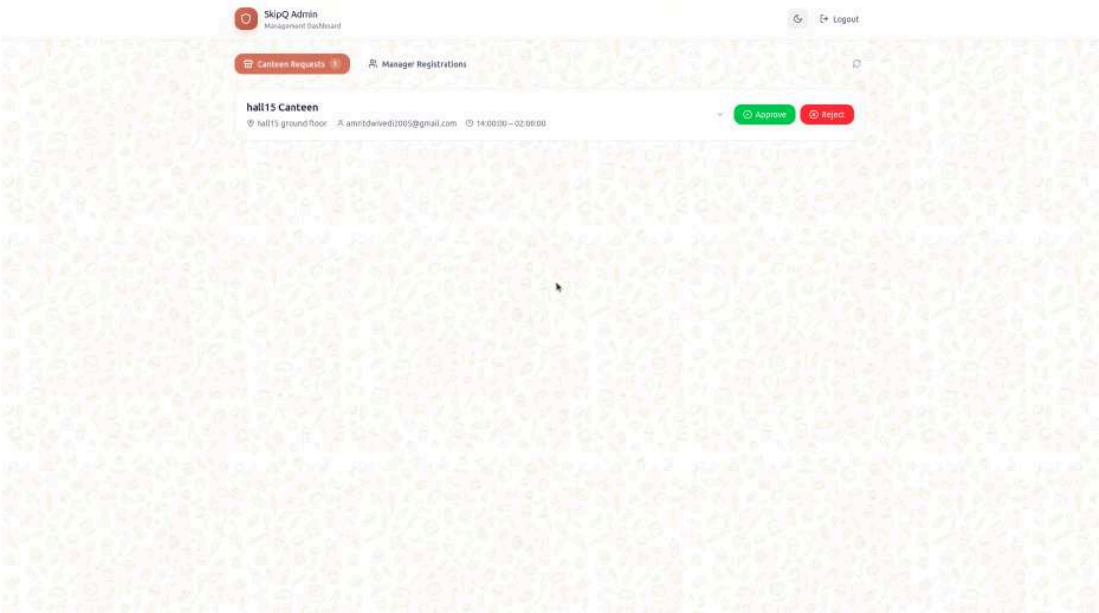
5. Guide for Administrators

5.1 Admin Login



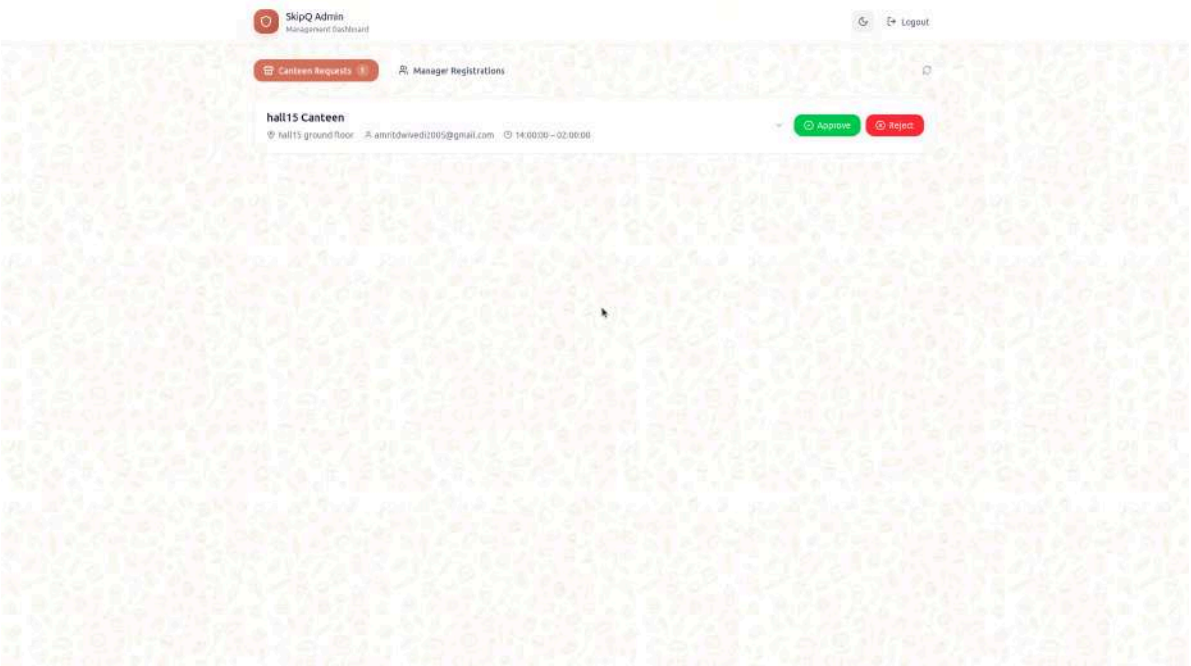
Admins use a separate login page at http://172.27.16.252:3000/admin/login.
Enter your admin email and password. On success, you are redirected to the Admin Panel.

5.2 Admin Panel Overview



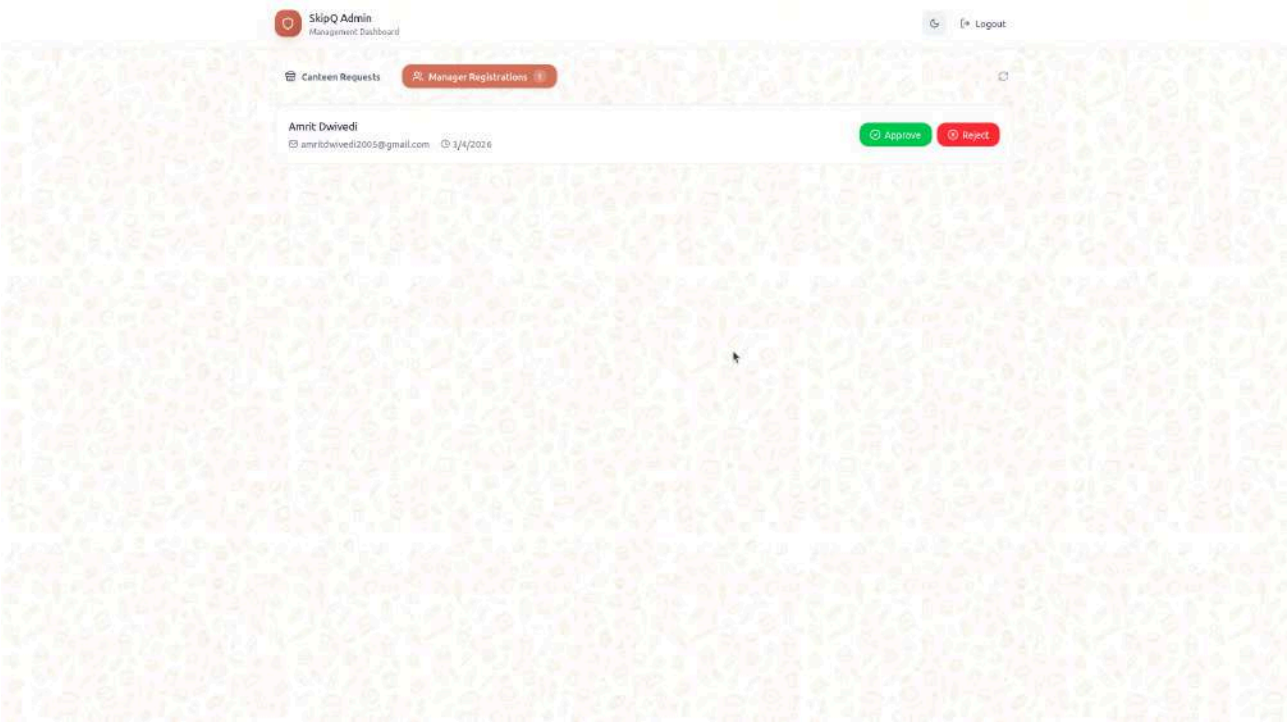
The Admin Panel provides centralized control over the entire platform.

5.2.1 Canteen Registration Requests



- View all pending canteen registration requests.
- Each request shows: manager name, email, canteen name, location, submitted registration documents, and submission date.
- **Expand** a request to view the full details and uploaded documents (Aadhaar card, Hall Approval Form).
- **Approve:** The canteen status changes to ACTIVE. It becomes visible to students. The manager's account is fully activated.
- **Reject:** The canteen is rejected. Provide a reason. A rejection notification is sent to the manager.

5.2.2 Manager Registration Requests



- View pending manager registrations that have not yet been linked to a canteen.
- **Approve:** Creates the user account and canteen manager profile. An approval email is sent.
- **Reject:** Rejects the registration with a reason. A rejection email is sent.

6. Troubleshooting & FAQ

6.1 Common Issues

Problem	Likely Cause	What to Do
Cannot log in	Wrong email or password	Use the Forgot Password flow to reset your password
Cannot place an order	Wallet PIN not set	Go to the Wallet page and set your 4 digit PIN first
Cannot place an order	Insufficient wallet balance	Add funds to your wallet before ordering
Cannot place an order	Canteen is closed	Check the canteen's operating hours and order when it is open
Cart emptied unexpectedly	Added items from a different canteen	Your cart only holds items from one canteen. Adding from another clears it (with a warning)
Order stuck on PENDING	Manager has not reviewed it yet	Wait for the canteen manager to accept or reject your order
Cannot rate a dish	Order not yet completed	Ratings are only available after the order reaches COMPLETED status
Cake reservation rejected	Various reasons	Check the rejection reason provided by the manager. Your advance payment is automatically refunded
Got logged out unexpectedly	Session expired	Log in again. Check "Remember Me" for a 31-day session
Page not loading properly	Stale browser cache	Try logging out, clearing your browser cache, and logging back in

6.2 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I order from multiple canteens at the same time?
A: No. Your cart can only hold items from one canteen. If you add items from a different canteen, your existing cart will be cleared (you will be warned first).
Q: What happens if the manager rejects my order?
A: Your wallet is automatically refunded the full order amount. You will see the refund reflected in your wallet balance instantly.
Q: Can I get my food delivered to my hostel?
A: No. SkipQ is currently pickup-only. You need to go to the canteen counter to collect your order once it is marked READY.
Q: How is the estimated wait time calculated?
A: It is based on the number of active orders (PENDING + ACCEPTED) ahead of yours. Each order adds roughly 5 minutes to the estimate.
Q: Can I change my email address?
A: No. Your email is tied to your identity and cannot be changed after registration. Contact an admin if you have a genuine need.
Q: How do I become a canteen manager?
A: Register through the Owner Registration page, then submit your canteen details. An admin must approve your request before you can start using the platform.
Q: Is my wallet PIN the same as my password?
A: No. Your password is used to log in. Your wallet PIN is a separate 4-digit code used only to authorise financial transactions (placing orders and cake reservations).

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7. Glossary

Term	Definition
SkipQ	The campus canteen food ordering platform for IIT Kanpur
Canteen	A food outlet on the IIT Kanpur campus
Customer	A registered IIT Kanpur student who places food orders
Manager	A canteen operator who manages orders and menus
Admin	A platform administrator with oversight over canteens and users
OTP	One-Time Password sent via email to verify your identity
Wallet PIN	A 4-digit numeric code required to authorize wallet transactions
SkipQ Wallet	The in-app digital wallet used for all payments on the platform
Lead Time	The minimum number of hours in advance required for a cake reservation (default: 6 hours)
Wait Time	The estimated time until your order is ready, based on queue position
FIFO	First-In-First-Out. Orders are processed in the order they were placed
State Machine	The defined set of valid states and transitions for orders, canteens, and cake reservations
Terracotta	The primary accent color (#D4725C) used throughout the SkipQ interface
Glass-morphism	The UI design style featuring translucent panels with backdrop blur